Everyday AI: Photos, video & music

20 step-by-step guides for real, everyday tasks

Photos, video & music

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Before you start — what this is, honestly

This is an updated edition. It was rebuilt from our current guides on the date shown on the cover: more guides per topic, retired guides removed, and every step taken from the latest version of each guide.

This collection is free, and every guide in it is also free on our website. This file just gathers them in one place, in reading order, so you can print it, keep it on your phone, or read it offline. Our website has no paywall either — every guide links back to its online page, which is always the newer version.

AI **Every guide in this pack was written by AI** and checked by automated fact and quality gates. **Our editor spot-checks published guides every day, but not every text is read by a person.** Every guide page on https://aiworldhq.com carries the same notice — we say it openly because you deserve to know who wrote what you are reading.

Apps change. Buttons move and menus get renamed. If a step does not match what you see, the guide's online version is the newer one — the link is under every title.

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What's inside

1. **Photos, video & music**
    1. How to generate AI images in Picsart: a beginner's step-by-step guide
    2. Auto-write captions for your photos using Hugging Face's free image captioning tool
    3. How to remove a photo background cleanly with Meta AI on your phone
    4. How to Write a Gemini Image Prompt That Gets Close to What You Pictured
    5. Generate unique profile pictures for social media with Midjourney
    6. Create a multi-room music playlist with Alexa+
    7. Sharpen Your Photos with AI Using Upscayl
    8. How to create images with AI: a beginner's first try
    9. How to Make Your First AI Video by Starting with a Simple Storyboard
    10. Safely Rename a Batch of Photos with a GitHub Copilot Script
    11. How to Summarize a Long YouTube Video in 60 Seconds with Any AI
    12. How to Ask ChatGPT for Step-by-Step Photo Editing Help in Your Phone's Editor
    13. Create Royalty-Free AI Music Loops for Podcasts and Videos
    14. Remove Distractions from Photos with Google Photos Magic Eraser
    15. How to use Kling AI video templates in Picsart Flow
    16. How to Turn Your Saved Articles and Notes into a Personal Podcast with Gemini Notebook
    17. How to label AI-made videos when you post them on YouTube, TikTok and Facebook
    18. How to Edit Your Phone Photos with Simple Text Instructions in Meta AI
    19. How to Sort and Clean Up a Messy Phone Photo Library with Gemini
    20. How to Generate Images with Google Gemini: A Beginner's Guide

Photos, video & music

How to generate AI images in Picsart: a beginner's step-by-step guide

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Picsart has a built-in AI image generator that turns your text prompts into pictures, then lets you keep editing in the same conversation. The AI tools usually sit behind a paid plan, and the engine works best with still images — not video.

If you've ever opened Picsart to fix a photo, design a poster, or make a quick thumbnail, the app already has an AI image generator tucked inside. Type a sentence, and Picsart turns it into a picture. Don't like something in the result? Stay in the same chat and ask for a change — the AI keeps the rest of the image intact. Here's how to try it, step by step, even if you've never touched an AI image tool before.

Before you start

- A Picsart account — sign-up is free, but AI image generation usually requires a paid plan. Check Picsart's current pricing page before you start.
- The Picsart app on your phone or tablet, or the web version in your browser at picsart.com.
- A rough idea of what you want to make: a poster, a product mock-up, a photo edit, or a wallpaper.
- About 10 minutes for your first image.

Step 1 — Open Picsart and find the AI image generator

Open the Picsart app and sign in. Once you're on the home screen, look for a tile, button, or section whose name suggests AI image generation — common labels include **AI Image Generator**, **AI Playground**, or **Text to Image**. If you don't see any of those on the main grid, tap the + (plus) button at the bottom-center of the screen, or look for a **Create** tab along the bottom row of icons — the AI tools usually live in one of those two places. On the web version at picsart.com, look in the top menu for something like **AI Tools** or **Create**.

💬 Example: this step has nothing to type — just finding the right entry point.

You'll know it worked when a screen appears with a text field where you can describe the image you want (usually called the prompt box) and at least one option to either start from text or upload a photo.

Step 2 — Pick your starting point: text, photo, or template

Inside the AI image tool, you'll usually see a few big choices near the top of the screen: **Text to Image** (start from a written description), **Image to Image** (start from a photo you upload), or a ready-made template you can fill in. Tap whichever fits what you want — for your first try, choose **Text to Image** if it's available. If the screen also shows a model selector — a small dropdown, a chip near the prompt box, or a tile in a side panel — pick whichever option is marked as the latest or recommended. Picsart rotates AI models over time, and the list changes often, so we won't name a specific one here.

Example: this step is a tap, not a typing step — the key choice is **Text to Image** for a first run.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty prompt box and a clearly labeled button like **Generate**, **Create**, or an arrow icon.

Step 3 — Choose a canvas size (if the app asks)

Before you write your prompt, some versions of the tool show a size or shape picker. If you see it — usually a small icon shaped like a square, a rectangle, or a phone outline, or a dropdown near the prompt box — pick the shape that matches where you'll use the picture. A square shape works for Instagram-style posts, a tall rectangle works for phone wallpapers and Stories, and a wide rectangle works for banners and YouTube thumbnails. If the app also shows a quality choice (sometimes labeled with letters or numbers like 1K, 2K, or 4K, where higher means sharper but slower), pick the lowest one for a quick test so you don't burn through your credits.

Example: for a square post, choose the square option; for a phone wallpaper, choose the tall rectangle; if you see a quality choice, pick the lowest setting for a quick test.

You'll know it worked when a small preview, a number, or a labeled chip on the screen shows the shape and size you picked.

Step 4 — Write your prompt and generate the image

In the prompt box, describe the picture you want in plain, specific language. Name the subject, the mood, the colors, the lighting, and any text you want visible on the image — Picsart says its AI image generator handles on-image text reasonably well, which is useful for posters and diagrams. The more concrete you are, the closer the result will be to what you imagined. Then tap the **Generate** button (sometimes labeled **Create** or shown as an arrow icon). After a few seconds, one or more images appear on screen — pick the one you like best, or tap **Regenerate** if none feel right.

Example: "A friendly poster for a Saturday morning yoga class, soft pastel colors, with the words 'Saturday Morning Yoga' clearly readable in the center, hand-drawn style."

You'll know it worked when a finished image appears on screen and matches the canvas shape you picked in Step 3.

Step 5 — Refine the image in the same chat

Here's where the in-chat editing saves time: you don't have to start over when something's off. Stay in the same conversation and send a follow-up message describing one specific change. The AI keeps the rest of the picture intact and adjusts only what you asked for. You can chain several refinements one after another — change colors, swap a background, add a logo, rewrite the on-image text — without losing the previous version. Be specific: name the exact color, the exact word, the exact object. If you can't find the chat box, look for a field at the bottom of the screen that says something like **Message**, **Ask anything**, or **Describe a change**.

💬 Example: after the yoga poster above, send: "Make the background soft pink, change the words to 'Bring a friend!', and add a small sun in the top-right corner."

You'll know it worked when the new image shows your specific change and the rest of the picture still looks like the previous version.

Step 6 — Edit an existing photo (optional)

If you'd rather start from a picture you already have, look for an **Upload** or **Image** button near the prompt box — usually shown as a small picture icon or a + sign. Tap it and pick a photo from your device. Once the photo appears, describe the edit you want in the prompt box. For finer control, look for a brush or markup tool near the image — common labels are **Mask**, **Edit**, or a small paint-bucket or brush icon. With that tool, drag your finger across the part of the photo you want changed; the painted area is the only part the AI will redraw. Then write a short note in the prompt box describing what should appear there. Be specific about what to remove, replace, or add.

💬 Example: upload a group photo, then type: "Remove the person in the red shirt on the right." Or paint over the background with the brush tool and write: "Replace this background with a sunset beach."

You'll know it worked when the edited photo appears with your specific change applied and the rest of the image still looks natural.

Step 7 — Save and export your image

When you're happy with the result, look for a **Save**, **Download**, or **Export** button — usually at the top-right corner of the image or inside a ⋯ (three dots) menu. The app may ask you to pick a file format: choose **JPG** for everyday sharing, or **PNG** if you need a transparent background

(for layering the image on top of other designs). The image then saves to your device's photo gallery or your computer's Downloads folder. If you want to keep editing the file inside Picsart later, look for a **Save to project** or **Save as draft** option instead.

💬 Example: not a typing step — the key choice is **JPG** for everyday sharing, **PNG** only if you need a transparent background.

You'll know it worked when the image file appears in your phone's gallery (or your computer's Downloads folder) and opens like any normal picture.

Common mistakes

- **Picking the wrong starting mode.** If you upload a photo but meant to start from text (or the other way around), the result will look off. In Step 2, double-check you've chosen the right mode — **Text to Image** or **Image to Image** — before tapping Generate.
- **Asking for vague edits.** "Make it better" or "fix it" gives the AI nothing to act on. Always name the specific change: a color, an object, a word, a mood. The more concrete the instruction, the closer the result.
- **Forgetting the cost.** Each generation usually spends credits or counts against your plan's allowance. A higher-quality image costs more than a lower-quality one, and each follow-up edit in the chat counts as another generation. Check your remaining credits before kicking off a long chain of edits — otherwise the tool may stop mid-conversation.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can make a custom birthday card, a flyer for a school bake sale, or a fun wallpaper for your phone — in minutes, without any design training.
- **For your business or work:** You can mock up a quick social-media post, an event poster, or a product visual to share with a colleague before commissioning a designer for the final version.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with one simple text-to-image prompt (Step 4) at the lowest quality setting. Get a feel for what the tool does well before moving on to photo edits or higher-quality output.

Try it now

Open Picsart, find the AI image generator, and create one square image of your favorite season — one sentence prompt, no edits, just see what comes back. Takes about two minutes.

Auto-write captions for your photos using Hugging Face's free image captioning tool

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Hugging Face hosts free AI demos in its "Spaces" section, including image captioning tools that describe a photo in one short sentence. You upload an image, wait a few seconds, and copy the text — no coding needed.

By the end of this guide, you'll know how to turn a pile of unlabeled vacation or family photos into one-line descriptions, ready to drop into a social media post, paste as alt text, or use to search your own library.

Before you start

- A free Hugging Face account (you can sign up with an email, or sign in with a Google or GitHub account if you have one already).
- A modern browser on a laptop or desktop — Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari all work. Phones work too, but a bigger screen makes uploading easier.
- 5–15 photos saved on your device, ideally as JPEG or PNG and under ~5 MB each so they upload quickly.
- Roughly 10 minutes for your first batch.

Step 1 — Create a free Hugging Face account

Open your browser and go to **huggingface.co**. Look for a **Sign up** button or link, usually near the top-right of the page. Type your email, pick a password, and confirm your inbox when the verification email arrives.

A free account lets you try any of the public demos. The page should land on your profile or the home feed once you're done.

💬 Example: the verification email is usually titled something like "Confirm your Hugging Face account".

If it looks different: if you already have an account, click **Log in** instead of Sign up — and if your browser saved an old login, you may skip straight to the homepage.

You'll know it worked when you see your profile picture or initials in the top-right corner of the page.

Step 2 — Find an image captioning Space

From the top menu, click **Spaces** — think of a Space as a small web app built by someone in the Hugging Face community. In the search bar on the Spaces page, type **image captioning** and press Enter. You'll see a list of community-built demos; look for ones with clear names related to image captioning (if it's available, you might find options with names like **BLIP Image Captioning** or **ViT-GPT2 Image Captioning**).

Don't worry about picking the "best" one. Most of these demos do the same basic job: read your photo and write one sentence about it.

💬 Example: searching for "BLIP image captioning" may return a Space built by Salesforce, which has been one of the popular captioning demos on the site.

If it looks different: if the search bar isn't obvious, try the **Filters** button, choose the **Computer Vision** category, and scroll until you spot a captioning demo.

You'll know it worked when you land on a page whose title mentions "Image Captioning" and shows an upload area or a button that says something like "Upload" or "Drop an image here".

Step 3 — Open the demo and wait for it to load

Click on the chosen Space to open it. The first time you visit, the demo may take 10–30 seconds to wake up — this is normal, since free demos often go to sleep when no one is using them. A progress bar, a spinner, or words like "Running" or "Starting" usually appear while it loads.

Once it's ready, you'll see an upload area and, on most Spaces, a short blurb explaining what the model does.

💬 Example: a typical blurb is "A short image captioning model based on BLIP, fine-tuned on COCO" — COCO is just the name of a popular photo dataset the model learned from.

If it looks different: if you only see a gray box for more than a minute, refresh the page once. If it still won't load, try a different captioning Space from the search results in Step 2.

You'll know it worked when the upload area becomes active — usually it says "Drop image here" or shows a small image icon.

Step 4 — Upload your first photo

Drag a single photo from your desktop into the upload area, or click the area to open a file picker and choose your picture. The photo appears as a small preview on the page. Don't upload dozens at once — most free demos are built to caption one image at a time.

Wait a few seconds. The caption will appear in a text box or label below the image.

💬 Example: a beach sunset photo might return something like "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds", and a family group shot might return "a group of people smiling and standing together".

If it looks different: if nothing happens after about 30 seconds, look for a **Submit** or **Run** button near the upload area — some Spaces require you to confirm the upload before they process it.

You'll know it worked when a short English sentence describing your photo appears in or near the upload area.

Step 5 — Try a few more photos to see the range

Pick 3–5 different photos — a landscape, a portrait, a pet, a city street, a close-up of food — and run them through the demo one at a time. This helps you see what the tool handles well and where it gets confused. You'll likely notice it's strong at obvious scenes (beaches, dogs, kitchens) and weaker at very specific or unusual images.

💬 Example: a clear photo of a coffee cup on a wooden table might come back as "a cup of coffee on a table" — accurate, but plain.

If it looks different: don't be surprised if the caption is generic ("a person standing outside") for busy scenes. That's the model playing it safe rather than guessing at details it can't see clearly.

You'll know it worked when you have a small list of captions that roughly match each photo's main subject.

Step 6 — Copy and store your captions

Highlight the caption text in the demo's output box and copy it with **Ctrl+C** on Windows or **Cmd+C** on Mac. Paste it into a notes app, a Google Doc, or a spreadsheet right next to the photo's filename. Repeat for each photo. There's no built-in batch export — the work is mostly copying and pasting one at a time.

💬 Example: a simple spreadsheet column might read `beach_sunset.jpg → "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds"`.

If it looks different: if the caption text isn't selectable, right-click the output area and choose **Copy** from the menu instead.

You'll know it worked when you have a tidy list of one-line descriptions you can reuse later.

Step 7 — Use your captions in real life

Now do something useful with them. For social media posts, paste a caption under your photo and tweak the wording if you want more personality. For alt text (the short description screen readers use for images on websites), paste it directly into the image's alt-text field. For organizing your own photo library, drop the captions into a folder named "_captions.txt" so you can search them later.

💬 Example: a LinkedIn post becomes "Wrapped up a long week with a walk on the beach 🌅 — a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds. Felt good to breathe."

If it looks different: alt-text fields look slightly different on every site — on a WordPress blog it's under "Image attributes", on X or Twitter it's the small alt field you fill in while uploading.

You'll know it worked when you stop staring at unlabeled photos thinking "what was this one again?"

Common mistakes

- **Uploading giant RAW files straight from a camera.** Free demos often struggle with files over ~10 MB, and some reject RAW formats entirely. Convert to JPEG first, or resize using your phone's built-in photo editor.
- **Expecting one upload to caption a whole album at once.** Most demos only handle one image at a time. Captioning 200 vacation photos means 200 separate uploads — plan for it to take a while, or pick a few favorites first.
- **Trusting the caption blindly.** Image captioning AI can mislabel things — it might call a labrador a "golden retriever" or skip a person in the background. Always glance at the caption before publishing or pasting it as alt text.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** captioning a personal photo for the first time feels like giving your camera a tiny voice. You can finally find that one sunset photo from three summers ago by searching the captions.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a blog, a small shop, or any website with lots of photos, alt text is something search engines and accessibility tools really do look at. Auto-captioning gives you a starting point in seconds — you then edit for accuracy and tone.
- **If you're just getting started:** skip the jargon and just play. Upload one photo of your pet, laugh at whatever the AI writes, and you've already learned the basics.

Try it now

Pick one favorite photo from your camera roll, open huggingface.co in your browser, search for "image captioning" in Spaces, upload the photo, and copy the caption. Two minutes, one photo,

one sentence — that's the whole loop.

How to remove a photo background cleanly with Meta AI on your phone

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram, upload a photo, and ask it to "remove the background." Meta AI will usually generate a transparent version you can save as a PNG. You'll get a clean cutout in about a minute, though fine details like frizzy hair or sheer fabric can still need a touch-up.

You already chat with Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram. This guide adds one more thing you can do there: turn any photo into a clean cutout (the photo with the background taken away) and drop it onto a new background, all from your phone, no Photoshop, no extra app. The whole workflow takes about five minutes once you've done it once.

Before you start

- **The app:** Meta AI built into **WhatsApp, Messenger, or Instagram** on your phone (iPhone or Android). If you can already chat with Meta AI in any of these, you're set.
- **A photo on your phone:** JPEG or PNG, ideally with a clear subject (a person, a product, a pet) and decent lighting. Busy, low-contrast backgrounds are the hardest to cut.
- **Roughly 5–10 minutes** for the first try, less after that.
- **Free.** No paid plan is required for the workflow below. Meta may rate-limit (cap how many times you can ask in a short window) on busy days, so have a backup photo ready.
- **What Meta AI can and can't do here:** it can usually remove a simple background in one go, but it is not pixel-perfect. Fine hair, glasses, and see-through materials can leave a faint halo (a soft glow around the edges of the cutout). It's great for social posts and product shots, less great for printing at poster size.

Step 1 — Open a Meta AI chat

Tap the **circular blue/purple Meta AI icon** — in WhatsApp it's usually at the top of your Chats tab or behind a **blue "AI" button** in the bottom-right; in Messenger it's the top of the search bar; in Instagram it's in the search/DMs area. If you don't see it, type **Meta AI** into the app's search bar. The chat screen opens, showing a short welcome message and the message box at the bottom. You'll know it worked when the box at the bottom says something like "Message Meta AI" or shows a send arrow.

Step 2 — Upload the photo you want to cut out

Tap the **paperclip or "+" icon** next to the message box to attach a file. From the menu that appears, pick **"Gallery"** (Android) or **"Photo & Video Library"** (iPhone) and choose the

photo. The image appears inside the chat as a small preview above the message box. If your app doesn't show a paperclip, look for a **camera icon** instead — the option is the same. Don't send the message yet; the prompt you add in the next step shapes what Meta AI does with the image.

💬 Example: choose a clear, well-lit photo of a friend standing in front of a plain wall, or a product on a tabletop.

You'll know it worked when the photo preview is sitting above the message box, ready to go with your next sentence.

Step 3 — Write the prompt that asks for the cutout

Tap the message box and type a short, direct instruction. Be specific: say "remove the background" rather than just "edit this." If you already know where you want to use the image, mention that too — it helps the model (the AI "brain" that reads your words and produces the answer) pick a sensible default background color.

💬 Example: `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.` Or, if you'd like a new background in the same step: `Remove the original background and place the person on a soft white studio background.`

Tap **send** (the paper-plane or arrow icon). Meta AI will usually reply within 10–30 seconds with a new version of your image. You'll know it worked when a new picture appears in the chat that looks like your subject on a flat color or transparent-looking background.

Step 4 — Check the edges before you save

Pinch to zoom in on the edges around the subject — especially around hair, fingers, glasses, and anything thin. Look for a faint color halo (a thin glowing outline) where the old background is bleeding through, or a slightly hard "stamped" edge. If the cut is clean, move to Step 5. If you see issues, stay in the same chat and ask for a fix in plain words.

💬 Example: `Zoom in around the hair — I can still see a faint gray halo. Please clean up the edges.` Or: `The fingers on the right hand look chopped. Please redo with finer edge detail.`

You'll know it worked when the second image shows noticeably cleaner edges than the first, with no obvious halo or missing fingers.

Step 5 — Save the new image to your phone

Long-press the new image Meta AI produced. A small menu appears with options like **"Save," "Save to Photos,"** or **"Download."** Tap the save option. The image lands in your phone's

Photos or Gallery app, usually in a folder called **Recents** or **Downloads**. If long-press doesn't show "Save," look for a **three-dot ⋯ menu** on the image instead, or tap the image to open it full-screen and then tap the **download/save icon** in the corner.

You'll know it worked when the new image appears in your Photos app as its own file, separate from the original you uploaded.

Step 6 — Drop the cutout onto a new background

Open any simple editor on your phone — the built-in **Photos** app on iPhone, or **Google Photos** on Android both work. Open the saved cutout, then tap **Edit**, and look for an option like **"Add Photo"** or **"Overlay / Sticker"** that lets you put a second image behind the first. Pick your new background — a sunset you took, a logo, a solid color. Resize and reposition, then save.

💬 Example: a beach sunset from your camera roll, so your friend looks like they're standing on vacation.

You'll know it worked when the final saved image shows your original subject, with clean edges, sitting naturally on the new background you chose.

Step 7 — Keep your reusable prompt in one easy-to-find place

Don't retype the prompt every time. Save the working version from Step 3 in your phone's **Notes app** or in the **Notes** feature of WhatsApp/Messenger itself, then copy-paste it next time. For even faster reuse, ask Meta AI in the same chat: `Save this as a reusable prompt I can paste next time.` Meta AI will usually reply with a tidy, copy-ready version you can keep.

💬 Example: `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background. Keep the subject exactly the same — only the background should change.`

You'll know it worked when, next time, you can paste the saved prompt, attach a photo, and get a clean cutout in under a minute.

Common mistakes

- **Asking vaguely.** "Edit my photo" is too open. Always name the change: "remove the background," "place the subject on white," "tighten the edges." A specific instruction gets a specific answer.
- **Uploading a tiny, blurry, or low-contrast photo.** If the subject and the background are similar colors (a black dog on a dark couch), Meta AI will struggle. Pick a photo with a clear difference between subject and background.
- **Saving the wrong image.** The chat shows both your original upload and the new generated image. Long-press the *new* one, not the one you sent. If you saved the original

by mistake, just repeat Step 3 and save the reply.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Clean cutouts are perfect for WhatsApp or Instagram stickers of your pet, a quick profile picture with a softer background, or a fun "I went to Paris" photo where you actually went to the kitchen. Five minutes of fiddling beats a desktop app you don't have time to learn.
- **For your business or work:** If you sell a few products on a side hustle, you can knock out consistent product photos for a catalog or marketplace listing without paying a designer. The edges won't be magazine-perfect, but they're good enough for a small storefront and free.
- **If you want to go further:** Try a two-step prompt in one chat — first remove the background, then ask `Now place the subject on a marble countertop with soft daylight from the left.` The model remembers the previous image in the same conversation, so each new instruction builds on the last one instead of starting over.

Try it now

Open Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram right now. Pick a photo of a person or object that is already on your camera roll, paste this prompt, and send:

💬 `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.`

Save the result to your phone. That's a complete, reusable workflow you can do again in under a minute next time.

How to Write a Gemini Image Prompt That Gets Close to What You Pictured

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can create images from a written description. Describing five things, the subject, setting, style, lighting and framing, usually gets you much closer to your picture on the first try. Image creation may depend on your account, location or plan.

You have a picture in your head, but Gemini can only work with the words you type. By the end of this guide, you'll know how to describe any image in five clear parts, so the result looks much more like what you had in mind. This is for anyone who has ever typed "a cat in a hat" and been surprised by the result.

Before you start

- A Google account, and access to the Gemini chat in a web browser or the Gemini app on your phone.
- Image creation may not be available in every region or on every plan. If you can't find an image option, it may not be switched on for your account yet.
- About 15 to 20 minutes. Most of that time is trying, looking and adjusting.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Open Gemini in your browser or app. Start a new chat, usually by tapping a pencil or "new chat" icon, so your image request isn't mixed up with older messages. You'll see an empty text box at the bottom of the screen, often with placeholder words like "Ask Gemini" or "Enter a prompt here." Those words may be different on your device. If you see a button or option for creating images, you can use it, but you can also simply type a request that starts with "Create an image of..." and see what happens. After you send it, Gemini usually replies with one or more pictures, sometimes taking a few seconds.

💬 Example: "Create an image of a friendly cup of coffee on a wooden table."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with a picture, or with a message explaining why it can't make one yet.

Step 2 — Name the subject

The subject is the main thing in the picture: a who, or a what. Be specific. "A dog" leaves Gemini guessing about breed, size and what it's doing. "A small brown dog with floppy ears, sitting and looking up" gives it real direction. Good subjects usually include one clear action or pose. Keep it to one or two main subjects at first, because crowded scenes are harder to get right. Write your

subject as a full phrase near the start of your prompt, so Gemini sees it first. If the subject is a real, named person, skip it: Gemini may not create images of real people, and it's safer to describe a made-up character instead.

- Example: "Create an image of a [animal or person] doing [one action] with [one object]."

You'll know it worked when your subject is clearly the first thing you notice in the result.

Step 3 — Describe the setting

The setting answers where and when. Think of it like a stage: the subject is the actor, and the setting is the backdrop. Name a place and, if it matters, a time of day or season. "In a kitchen" is vague; "in a small sunny kitchen with white tiles" paints a clearer scene. Add one or two background details, such as "with plants on the windowsill," so the scene feels finished. Don't overload it with dozens of objects, since Gemini may add or drop small things anyway.

- Example: "...in a [place] during [time of day]."

You'll know it worked when the background matches the place you named, even if the details differ a little.

Step 4 — Choose a style

The style tells Gemini how the picture should look: a photograph, a watercolor painting, a cartoon, an oil painting or a 3D-style render. This single word can change the whole mood, so it's one of the most useful ingredients. If you want realism, say "photo-like." If you want something playful, say "cartoon style with bold outlines." You can also name a mood, like "calm" or "cheerful." Avoid naming a living artist to copy their exact look; describing the style in your own words is simpler and works just as well.

- Example: "...in a soft watercolor style with pale, gentle colors."

You'll know it worked when the result looks like the kind of picture you described, whether that's a painting, a photo or a drawing.

Step 5 — Add the lighting

Lighting is the difference between a flat picture and one with atmosphere. Name where the light comes from and how it feels: "warm morning sunlight from the left," "soft overcast light," "candlelight," or "a neon glow at night." Lighting also helps set the mood, so it's worth a few words. If you don't mention lighting at all, Gemini will choose something for you, which is fine for quick tests but less predictable when you want a specific look. One clear light source is easier to get right than several.

Example: "...lit by [light source] coming from [direction]."

You'll know it worked when the shadows and brightness in the picture roughly match the light you described.

Step 6 — Choose the framing

Framing is how the camera sees the scene. Is it a close-up of a face, a wide shot of a landscape, or a view from above? Words like "close-up," "medium shot," "wide shot," "eye level" and "bird's-eye view" are easy to type and make a big difference. If you're not sure, "a medium shot at eye level" is a safe starting point for most subjects. Framing also decides how much of the subject is visible, so say whether you want the whole thing or just part of it.

Example: "Framed as a [shot type] from [angle]."

You'll know it worked when the subject's size and position on the screen match the framing you asked for.

Step 7 — Combine the five parts, send, and refine

Now put everything into one flowing prompt, in this order: subject, setting, style, lighting, framing. Send it, then look at the result carefully. Change one ingredient at a time, such as "make the lighting warmer," so you can see what actually changed. Gemini can usually make a new version when you ask it to adjust, and you can keep going until the picture is close to your idea. It won't read your mind, so small details like exact colors or the number of objects may still differ, and that's normal.

Example: "Create an image of a small brown dog with floppy ears, sitting on a porch in a quiet village at sunset, in a soft watercolor style, lit by warm evening light from the left, framed as a medium shot at eye level."

You'll know it worked when the picture matches most of your five parts, and any remaining differences are things you can fix with one small change.

Common mistakes

- **Writing a single vague word.** "A beautiful landscape" leaves almost everything open. The fix is to add at least a place, a style and a light source, even in short phrases.
- **Piling on too many ideas at once.** Ten objects, three styles and two light sources confuse the result. The fix is to pick one main subject and one clear style, then add details gradually.
- **Expecting a perfect copy on the first try.** Gemini works from words, not from your memory of the picture. The fix is to treat the first result as a draft and adjust one part at a

time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Make a birthday card design, a picture for a family slideshow, or a cozy illustration for a bedtime story your child can help describe.
- **For your business or work:** Sketch a rough visual for a flyer, presentation or social post before you hire someone to make the final version, and check that any image you use is appropriate for your purpose.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with subject and style only. Once that works, add setting, lighting and framing one at a time.

Try it now

Think of one simple picture you've been imagining, such as a bowl of soup by a rainy window. Write one sentence that names the subject, setting, style, lighting and framing, then send it to Gemini. Compare the result with your picture, and change just one word to see how it shifts.

Generate unique profile pictures for social media with Midjourney

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Midjourney is an AI image generator. In this guide you use it inside Discord: you type /imagine with a short description, get four options, pick one, and save it as your new profile picture. You need a Midjourney subscription.

A profile picture is often the first thing people see about you online. With Midjourney you can describe the look you want, such as a cartoon portrait or a watercolor avatar, and get several versions in about a minute. This guide uses Midjourney's Discord bot. You can also create on the Midjourney website; Midjourney's own docs explain both.

Before you start

- **A Midjourney subscription.** Midjourney's Discord Quick Start says you need a subscription before you can create images. Check the plans on midjourney.com.
- **A Discord account** and the Discord app or website.
- **About 15–20 minutes** for your first few tries.

Step 1: Join the Midjourney server on Discord

Open Discord and find the server list on the left side. Press the + button at the bottom of the list, click **Join a Server**, then paste the official invite link `http://discord.gg/midjourney` and press **Join**.

Then open a channel where the bot works. Midjourney's docs say to use any channel labeled **general-#** or **newbie-1** through **newbie-10**. The bot does not generate images in other channels on its server.

You'll know it worked when the Midjourney server appears in your server list and you can open one of those channels.

Step 2: Start your first image with /imagine

A **prompt** is the text description you give the AI. Type / in the message box, and a list of commands appears. Keep typing until you see **/imagine**, click it, type your description into the prompt field, and press **Enter**. The first time, the Midjourney Bot asks you to accept its Terms of Service before it creates anything.

💬 Example: `/imagine prompt: a cheerful fox wearing round glasses, cartoon style, bright colors`

You'll know it worked when the bot starts working on your request. Midjourney says it creates four image options within a minute. If you don't see any Midjourney commands, check Midjourney's command troubleshooting tips.

Step 3: Write a prompt for a profile picture

Be specific about the subject, mood, style, colors, and background. Words like "portrait," "headshot," or "close-up" help keep the focus on one face. Midjourney's docs say images use a square 1:1 aspect ratio by default, which suits most profile picture slots. If you have changed your default settings, add `--ar 1:1` at the end of the prompt to keep the image square.

💬 Example: `/imagine prompt: [describe the person or character], smiling gently, digital art portrait, soft pastel colors, simple background --ar 1:1`

You'll know it worked when your prompt includes who or what is in the picture, a style, and a simple background.

Step 4: Review your grid of four images

You'll get a grid of four images with two rows of buttons under it:

- **U1, U2, U3, U4** separate one image from the grid, so it's easier to download and edit. In current Midjourney versions, these buttons no longer make the image bigger.
- **V1, V2, V3, V4** create a new grid of variations based on one image.
- The 🔄 button reruns your prompt for a fresh grid.

The numbers follow the grid: 1 is top left, 2 is top right, 3 is bottom left, and 4 is bottom right.

You'll know it worked when you can see the grid and both rows of buttons.

Step 5: Pick your favorite and adjust it

Click the **U** button for the image you like best. Once it is separated, more options appear, including **Vary (Strong)** and **Vary (Subtle)** for new versions, **Zoom Out** to extend the background, the arrow buttons to extend the image in one direction, and **Web** to open the image on midjourney.com. If you want it larger, Midjourney's docs describe **Upscale (Subtle)**, which keeps the look close to the original, and **Upscale (Creative)**, which adds new details. Upscaling uses more of your subscription's GPU time.

You'll know it worked when a single image of your choice appears with the extra buttons below it.

Step 6: Save your new profile picture

Midjourney's docs say: on a computer, click the image to open it at full size, then right-click and choose **Save image**. On a phone, long-tap the image and then tap the download icon. Your images are also available on midjourney.com when you log in with your Discord account.

You'll know it worked when the image file opens in your photos or files app.

Step 7: Refine or try again

If the result isn't quite right, try **Vary (Subtle)** for small changes, or write a new /imagine prompt with clearer details. Midjourney also has **Vary Region** in Discord for regenerating one part of an image. Small, step-by-step changes to your wording usually work better than starting over every time.

You'll know it worked when a new version gets closer to the picture you have in mind.

Common mistakes

- **A vague prompt.** "Person" gives a very generic result. *The fix:* Describe the face, expression, clothing, style, and background.
- **Using the wrong channel.** On the Midjourney server, the bot only works in its general and newbie channels. *The fix:* Use a **general-#** or **newbie-1** to **newbie-10** channel.
- **Expecting U buttons to enlarge the image.** In current versions they only separate the image. *The fix:* Use **Upscale (Subtle)** or **Upscale (Creative)** when you really need a bigger file.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can make a profile picture or avatar that matches your personality, without needing a photo shoot.
- **For your business or work:** You can create a consistent illustrated look for a small team or project page. Check your workplace's rules on AI images first.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with a cartoon or illustrated style. It is easier to get a pleasing result than with a realistic portrait.

Try it now

Open Discord, go to a **newbie** channel on the Midjourney server, and type: `/imagine prompt: a friendly astronaut with a big smile, cartoon style, bright colors`. Pick your favorite with a U button and save it.

Create a multi-room music playlist with Alexa+

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Alexa+ you can set up a voice routine so a single phrase — like "Alexa, play my dinner playlist" — starts the same music in every room at once. It uses the Alexa app's Routines feature.

Imagine saying "Alexa, play my dinner playlist" and the same music starts in the kitchen, lounge and bedroom at once. You'll learn how to set up one playlist that plays across multiple rooms with a single voice command.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** (free).
- The **Alexa app** installed on your phone or tablet (Android or iOS).
- At least one **Amazon Echo device** (like an Echo Dot, Echo Show or Echo Studio) in each room.
- A **music streaming service** already linked to Alexa (Amazon Music, Spotify, Apple Music, etc.).
- Roughly **15 minutes** of your time.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and go to Devices

Open the Alexa app on your phone or tablet. At the bottom of the screen you'll see a row of icons — look for the one that looks like a **house outline** (this is the Devices section). Tap it. You should see a list of all your Echo devices, often grouped by room.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows your rooms and devices.

Example: Look for the house-shaped icon at the bottom of the Alexa app and tap it.

Step 2 — Pick a room to start

Choose the room where you want the music to begin. Tap the room name (for example, "Kitchen"). Inside that room view, look for a menu option — this is typically a **three-dot menu (⋯)** in the top-right corner, though on some app versions it may appear as a **gear icon** or a **menu with three lines** instead.

You'll know it worked when a menu slides up or opens from the bottom of the screen.

Example: Open the Kitchen room and look for the ⋯ menu in the top-right corner.

Step 3 — Find the routine option in the menu

From the menu that just appeared, look for an option to add this room to a routine — the exact wording may be **"Add to Routine"** or something similar depending on your app version. Tap it.

If you're not sure which option it is, look for any menu item that mentions "routine" or "routine" in English — this is the feature that links your voice phrase to your music action.

You'll know it worked when a routine setup screen opens.

Example: Tap **Add to Routine** (or the equivalent option in your app version).

Step 4 — Choose a voice trigger

In the routine setup screen, look for the option to set a **voice trigger** — on many versions this is labeled **"Voice"** and shown with a microphone icon. Tap it. A text box appears where you can type the phrase you want to say to Alexa to start the playlist.

If the voice option isn't visible, look through the list of available trigger types for something related to speaking or voice commands.

You'll know it worked when a text box opens for the phrase you want to say.

Example: Tap the voice trigger option and then tap inside the text box.

Step 5 — Type your wake-up phrase

Type the short phrase you'll say after "Alexa" — leave out the word "Alexa" itself. For example:
"play dinner playlist"

Confirm the phrase and move to the next step. Alexa may show a summary of the phrase you've entered.

You'll know it worked when the summary confirms your exact phrase.

Example: Type "play dinner playlist" and confirm it. Later you'll say "Alexa, play dinner playlist".

Step 6 — Add the music action

In the routine setup, look for an action type related to music — this may be labeled **"Music"** (often with a musical note icon) or something similar depending on your app version. Tap it. A

new screen opens where you can pick the playlist and the devices that should play it.

If you don't see a music option right away, look through the list of available actions for anything about playing audio or music.

You'll know it worked when you see options to choose a playlist and to choose which devices or rooms should play it.

Example: Tap the music action and then tap the option to choose a playlist.

Step 7 — Pick your playlist and devices

Select the playlist you want to play everywhere. Then choose all the rooms where you want the music to play (for example, Kitchen, Lounge, Bedroom) — look for a device or room picker. Save the routine.

You'll know it worked when the routine summary shows your chosen playlist and all the rooms you selected.

Example: Select "Dinner Vibes" playlist and tick Kitchen, Lounge and Bedroom.

Common mistakes

- **Wrong room selected** — If the music only plays in one room, double-check Step 2 and make sure you picked the correct room before saving the routine.
- **Phrase already used** — If Alexa says the phrase is taken, add a word like "my" or change the wording slightly (for example, "Alexa, start dinner playlist").
- **Device not selected** — If a room is missing, go back to Step 7 and make sure every room is ticked before saving.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Set up a "Good morning" routine that plays your favorite news podcast in the bedroom and kitchen at the same time.
- **For your business or work:** Create a "Focus time" routine that plays lo-fi beats in every meeting room whenever you say "Alexa, start focus time".
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one room and one playlist; once it works, add more rooms in the same routine.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, go to Devices, pick a room, tap the menu icon → look for a routine option → choose voice trigger → type your phrase → add a music action → pick your playlist and devices → Save. Say the phrase out loud to test it.

Sharpen Your Photos with AI Using Upscayl

6 steps · Read online

Do you have a cherished photo that's just a little bit blurry, or an old snap you wish looked sharper and ready for a larger print? This guide will show you how to use the free AI image super-resolution application, Upscayl, to quickly enhance your images. By the end, you'll be able to give your photos a professional, crisp finish, making them poster-worthy in minutes.

Before you start

- **Install the free Upscayl application:** You'll need to download and install Upscayl on your computer. It's an open-source tool, which means it's developed by a community and freely available for use.
- **A computer with a dedicated graphics card (GPU) is recommended:** While Upscayl can run on most systems, a graphics card (like an NVIDIA, AMD, or Intel Arc GPU) will significantly speed up the processing of your images, making the enhancement much faster.
- **A photo to enhance:** Choose a digital image that's slightly blurry or low-resolution that you'd like to improve.
- **Time:** Allow around 5-7 minutes to follow the steps and enhance your first image. Upscayl is free to use with no hidden costs.

Step 1 — Launch Upscayl

First, open the Upscayl application on your computer. Look for its distinctive icon on your desktop, in your Start menu (Windows), Applications folder (macOS), or program launcher (Linux), and double-click it. When it launches, you'll typically see its main window, often featuring a clean interface with a central area to load images and various options organized on the side. This is your starting point for transforming your photos. **If it looks different:** If it's your very first time launching Upscayl, you might see a quick setup or welcome screen, possibly asking to confirm default file paths or to download initial AI models. Follow any clear on-screen prompts to complete this setup before proceeding. **You'll know it worked when:** The Upscayl application window fully appears on your screen, indicating it's ready for you to select an image and begin the enhancement process.

Step 2 — Load Your Image

Now it's time to bring in the photo you want to improve. In the Upscayl window, you'll usually find a prominent button labeled "Open Image" or a clear "Drag and Drop" area in the center of the screen. Click the "Open Image" button, and your computer's file browser window (like File

Explorer on Windows or Finder on macOS) will pop up. Navigate to where your blurry photo is stored on your computer, select it with a click, and then click "Open." Your chosen image will then appear in the main Upscayl window, usually displayed as a clear preview. **If it looks different:** If the image doesn't load immediately, an error appears, or the preview area remains empty, ensure your photo is in a common format like JPG, PNG, or WEBP. You might also try restarting the application and attempting to load the image again. **You'll know it worked when:** Your selected photo is clearly visible within the Upscayl application's main preview area, confirming it has been loaded successfully and is ready for enhancement. 💬 Example: Select a file named `old_family_photo.jpg` from your `Pictures` folder.

Step 3 — Choose an AI Model

With your photo loaded, you need to tell Upscayl which "recipe" or AI model to use for the enhancement. Think of an AI model as a specialized algorithm (a set of computational instructions) that the AI follows to intelligently reconstruct and add detail to your image. Each model is trained differently and can produce slightly varied results depending on the original image. On the left side of the Upscayl window, you'll see a "Models" section with a list of AI options like "Real-ESRGAN," "Remacri," or "Ultramix_Balanced." Click on a model to select it; for general photos, "Real-ESRGAN" or "Ultramix_Balanced" are excellent starting points known for good all-round performance. **If it looks different:** If you don't see many models listed, or options are greyed out, you might need to download additional models within Upscayl's settings. Look for a "Download Models" button or an option to manage models in the application's configuration or preferences menu. **You'll know it worked when:** The name of the model you clicked is clearly highlighted or appears as the active selection, indicating that Upscayl will use this specific AI algorithm for processing.

Step 4 — Select Upscale Factor

Next, you'll decide how much larger you want your image to become. The "upscale factor" determines how many times the image's width and height will be multiplied, significantly increasing its total number of pixels and its overall resolution. For example, a 2x factor makes the image twice as wide and twice as tall (quadrupling the total pixels), while a 4x factor makes it four times wider and four times taller (sixteen times the total pixels). Below the models section, you'll typically find options for "Upscale Factor," often presented as buttons like 2x, 3x, 4x, or sometimes a custom size. Select "4x" for a significant improvement in detail and resolution for most images, providing a good balance of quality and processing time. **If it looks different:** Some AI models are specifically designed for particular upscale factors, so if an option like "4x" is greyed out, try selecting "2x" or "3x" instead. Alternatively, you might need to switch to a different AI model (as described in Step 3) that supports a higher factor. **You'll know it**

worked when: The "4x" option (or your chosen upscale factor) is clearly selected or highlighted in the Upscayl interface, confirming your desired output size.

Step 5 — Start the Enhancement

Once your photo is loaded and you've selected your preferred AI model and upscale factor, it's time to let the AI do its work. Look for a prominent button, usually positioned at the bottom right of the Upscayl window, labeled "Upscayl" or "Enhance." Click this button to begin the super-resolution process. Depending on your computer's processing power (especially if you have a dedicated graphics card like an NVIDIA RTX GPU) and the original image size, this can take anywhere from a few seconds to a minute or two. You might see a progress bar, a spinning icon, or a message indicating that the AI is actively processing your image. **If it looks different:** If the "Upscayl" or "Enhance" button appears greyed out or inactive, double-check that you've successfully loaded an image and made definite selections for both the AI model and the upscale factor. All required options must be chosen to activate the enhancement button. **You'll know it worked when:** The progress indicator disappears, and Upscayl either displays the enhanced image in a side-by-side view or automatically prompts you to save it.

Step 6 — Review and Save Your Enhanced Image

After the AI has finished processing, you'll see your newly enhanced image. Take a moment to compare it with the original; Upscayl often provides a side-by-side comparison or an easy toggle to switch between the two. Notice the improved sharpness, clarity, and detail in areas that were once blurry or pixelated. If you're pleased with the result, Upscayl will usually prompt you with a "Save As" dialogue box, which is your computer's standard file explorer. Choose a location on your computer to save your crisp new poster-ready photo, and give it a descriptive name so you can easily find it later. **If it looks different:** If a "Save As" prompt doesn't automatically appear, look for a "Save" or "Export" button within the Upscayl application itself. Some versions might also automatically save the enhanced image to a default folder (like "Pictures" or "Downloads") if no prompt is explicitly given. **You'll know it worked when:** You have a new, sharper, and higher-resolution version of your photo saved as a separate file on your computer, ready for use. While Upscayl can significantly enhance your photos, it cannot perfectly invent details from an extremely blurry or tiny original image that were never present in the first place, but it can significantly improve clarity.

Common mistakes

- **Not downloading AI models:** Upscayl relies on various specialized AI models to perform its magic, and not all are included in the initial application installation.
    - **The fix:** If you see few or no options in the "Models" section (Step 3), go into Upscayl's settings or preferences and look for a "Download Models" or "Manage

Models" option to acquire more AI algorithms.

- **Choosing the wrong AI model:** Different models are optimized for different image types (e.g., general photos, illustrations, specific art styles). Using a model designed for, say, anime on a family portrait might give unnatural or distorted results.
    - **The fix:** Experiment! If an image looks strange after processing, try re-loading the original and selecting a different model. "Real-ESRGAN" or "Ultramix_Balanced" are generally good choices for everyday photos and realistic images.
- **Expecting miracles from extremely low-quality sources:** While AI super-resolution is powerful, it cannot invent information that simply isn't there in the original image. An image that is completely out of focus, heavily pixelated, or tiny from the outset will still have significant limitations even after enhancement.
    - **The fix:** Aim for input photos that are only moderately blurry or low-resolution. The better the starting material (even if just slightly), the more impressive and natural the AI's final result will be.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can rescue cherished old photos that are a bit blurry, prepare family pictures for larger prints or digital display, or make your social media images stand out with professional-level sharpness and detail.
- **For your business or work:** Enhance product photos for e-commerce listings, sharpen images for presentations or marketing materials, or improve scans of documents and graphics to make them clearer and more legible for your audience and colleagues.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one of your favorite slightly blurry photos – perhaps a holiday snap or an old family picture – and follow this guide. Start by selecting the "Real-ESRGAN" model and a 4x upscale factor. Seeing the transformation firsthand is the best way to understand the power of AI image enhancement.

Try it now

Grab a photo that needs a little boost, launch the free Upscayl application, and follow these steps to give it a fresh, crisp look in the next few minutes.

How to create images with AI: a beginner's first try

6 steps · Read online

Imagine typing a simple sentence and watching a brand-new, unique image appear on your screen in seconds. It's like having a digital artist ready to bring any idea to life, no drawing skills required. Whether you want to design a custom greeting card, create a visual for a work presentation, or just visualise a creative thought, **AI image generators** make it possible. By the end of this guide, you will know how to choose a free tool, write a description that the AI understands, and be aware of how you can use your new creations.

Before you start

- **A computer or smartphone** with an internet connection and a web browser.
- **A free account** with an AI image generation platform. Many trusted companies offer free ways to create images — for this guide, we suggest exploring **Microsoft Copilot** (at copilot.microsoft.com) or **Canva** (at canva.com), as both have options to create images without needing a paid subscription. You'll need to sign up for a free account if you don't already have one.
- **Roughly 10-15 minutes** of time to follow along with the steps and create your first images.

Step 1 — Choose and open a free tool

Your first action is to pick a free online tool and open it in your web browser. You don't need to spend money to try this out, as many trusted companies offer free **AI image generators** — these are smart computer programs that act like a digital artist, translating your written words into pictures. We'll use Microsoft Copilot as our primary example.

Open your web browser and go to `copilot.microsoft.com`. If you're not logged in, you'll see a screen asking you to sign in with a Microsoft account or create one. Once you're signed in, you'll see the Copilot interface. **If it looks different:** If you're using Canva, open `canva.com` and log in. Then look for AI-related features, often found in the design creation flow or through a search function. **You'll know it worked when** you see the main interface of your chosen tool, ready for you to input commands or search for tools.

Step 2 — Find the image generator

Now that you're in the tool, you need to tell it you want to create an image. In Microsoft Copilot, look for the image generation feature — this may be a dedicated button, a mode toggle, or you can simply describe what you want in the chat. Type a simple instruction into the input area. When you do this, you're giving a **prompt** to the AI – this is just a fancy word for the

instruction you write to tell the AI what you want to see. **If it looks different:** In Canva, explore the AI image creation options, which may be labeled differently or located in various places within the design interface. **You'll know it worked when** the tool responds by acknowledging your image request, or when a dedicated image generation interface appears with a specific text box for your image description.

Example:

> "Create an image of"

Step 3 — Write your first detailed "prompt"

To get a great result, your **prompt** (the instruction) needs to be more than just one or two words. Think of it like giving a detailed recipe to a chef – the more specific you are, the better the dish will be! A good prompt usually has three main ingredients:

1. **The Subject:** Who or what is the main focus of the picture (e.g., "a fluffy ginger cat").
2. **The Details:** What they are doing, the colors, and the background (e.g., "wearing a blue knitted jumper, sitting on a wooden park bench, bright sunny day").
3. **The Style:** Do you want a realistic photo, a watercolour painting, a 3D cartoon, or something else (e.g., "soft watercolour painting style").

Now, type your complete, detailed description into the text box and send it. The AI will then start processing your request. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems confused, try rephrasing your request slightly, such as "Generate a picture that shows..." instead of "Create an image of...". **You'll know it worked when** you see a message like "Generating your image..." or a loading indicator, confirming the AI is working on your request.

Example:

> "A fluffy ginger cat wearing a blue knitted jumper, sitting on a wooden park bench, bright sunny day, soft watercolour painting style."

Step 4 — Generate and review your images

After you send your detailed prompt, the AI will get to work. It usually creates a few different image options based on your description. This process can take anywhere from a few seconds to about half a minute, depending on the tool and how busy it is.

Once the AI has finished, you'll see a collection of images appear on your screen, usually displayed side-by-side or in a grid. Take a moment to look at them. Don't worry if they're not absolutely perfect yet – this is just the first draft! This step shows you the AI's interpretation of your words. **If it looks different:** Some tools might generate only one image at a time, or

show a progress bar as they work. If the images look completely wrong, double-check your prompt for any typos or unclear instructions. **You'll know it worked when** you see your newly generated images displayed clearly on your screen, all inspired by the description you provided.

Step 5 — Refine or download your favorite

You don't have to settle for the first set of images. Most AI tools allow you to refine your results, just like talking to a helpful assistant. You can ask for changes to the images you see or generate completely new ones with a tweaked prompt.

If you want to make changes, simply type a follow-up instruction. If you're happy with an image, look for a "Download" or "Save" button, which is often an arrow pointing downwards or a disk icon, usually found near the individual image or at the bottom of the collection. Clicking this will save the image to your device. **If it looks different:** The download button might be hidden behind a "..." (three dots) menu or a right-click option. If you're refining, some tools let you select a specific image to refine, while others apply changes to the whole set. **You'll know it worked when** you either see a new set of images based on your refinements, or you've successfully saved an image file to your computer or phone.

Example:

> "Change the jumper color to yellow, and add a small friendly magpie sitting on the bench next to the cat."

Step 6 — Review your image for watermarks and usage

Before you share your AI masterpiece, it's helpful to understand two quick concepts: **watermarks** and **usage rights**. Take a close look at the images you've generated.

A **watermark** is a faint, semi-transparent logo or symbol placed in the corner of an image to show which tool created it. Many free tools include these automatically to keep the images easily recognizable as AI-made. Next, think about **usage rights**, which are the rules for how you can use the images. As a general rule, images you make on free accounts are perfect for personal fun, sharing with friends, or school projects. However, if you plan to use them to make money (like on a commercial website or product packaging), you must check the tool's terms of service (their official list of rules) as some free tiers do not allow commercial use. **If it looks different:** Some tools might offer a paid plan to remove watermarks, or their terms of service might be difficult to find. Look for a "Terms" or "Legal" link, usually at the bottom of the website. **You'll know it worked when** you can identify if your image has a watermark, and you have a general understanding of whether your chosen free tool allows personal or commercial use of your creation.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague:** Typing "a dog" gives the AI too much room to guess. You might end up with a cartoon pug when you wanted a realistic golden retriever.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Add details about the breed, color, action, and setting (e.g., "A golden retriever puppy frolicking in a field of sunflowers, hyperrealistic photo style").
- **Expecting perfect text spelling:** AI image generators are brilliant with shapes and colors, but they often struggle to spell words inside images. If you ask for a sign that says "Welcome", the AI might print scrambled letters or strange symbols.
    - **The fix:** It's usually best to avoid asking the AI to generate text within your images. Create the image first, then add text later using a separate image editing tool.
- **Forgetting that AI does not know real people:** For safety and privacy reasons, free tools will not let you generate realistic images of real public figures, celebrities, or your friends.
    - **The fix:** Stick to fictional characters, general subjects, or broad descriptions (e.g., "a young woman reading a book" rather than "Sarah reading a book").

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can instantly create custom birthday invitations, organize your home with beautifully styled labels, or make a unique phone wallpaper that no one else has – all with just a few words.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly mockup visual ideas for presentations, create colorful backdrops for social media posts, or brainstorm logo concepts without spending hours searching through generic stock photo libraries.
- **If you're just getting started:** Remember that experimenting is half the fun. There are no wrong answers, and the more you practice describing your ideas, the better and more accurate your results will be.

Try it now

Let's get you started right now. Open Microsoft Copilot or Canva in a new tab, find the image generator function, and type this simple prompt:

*"A friendly koala wearing a green scarf, holding a warm mug of tea, soft digital illustration style"

How to Make Your First AI Video by Starting with a Simple Storyboard

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Before you generate anything, write four to six numbered shots, each with what appears on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and what is said. Then generate one shot at a time. The most important thing to know: AI video tools usually make short clips, so plan your video as a series of short pieces.

Making your first AI video is much less frustrating when you know what you want before you type a single word. In this guide you will write a simple storyboard, turn each shot into a request for an AI video generator, and stitch the clips into one short video. It is written for complete beginners, so no experience with video or AI is needed.

Before you start

- **An AI video generator account.** Many generators, such as Sora, Veo, Runway or Pika, ask you to sign up with an email address. Some have a limited free option, and longer or higher-quality videos may need a paid plan. Check the official pricing page before you commit.
- **A simple place to write.** A notebook, a notes app or a document works fine.
- **A basic video editor.** Your phone or computer probably has one built in. Any simple editor that lets you drag clips into order will do.
- **Time:** about 60 to 90 minutes for your first video, including waiting for clips to render.

Step 1 — Choose one small idea

Pick a subject that fits in 15 to 30 seconds. Good first ideas are a cup of coffee steaming on a windowsill, a dog running across a park, or a paper boat floating down a puddle. Keep it to one place, one main subject and one feeling. A simple idea gives the AI fewer things to get wrong.

Write your idea in one sentence at the top of your page. Then ask yourself: what should the viewer feel at the end? If you can answer that in a few words, you are ready.

Honest note: AI video tools cannot read your mind. They work best when the idea is clear and specific, so spend a minute making it both.

💬 Example: write something like "A calm morning in a small kitchen, with steam rising from a mug of tea."

You'll know it worked when you can describe your video in one sentence that a friend could picture without any extra explanation.

Step 2 — Write four to six numbered shots

A shot is one continuous view from the camera, like one scene before a cut. On your page, draw a numbered list. For each shot, write three things: what appears on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and any words that are spoken. Keep each shot to about 3 to 6 seconds, since many AI clips are short.

If you are not sure how to break your idea into shots, a chat assistant can help you draft the list. You still make the final choices. Tell it how long you want the video to be, then read its suggestion and change anything that does not match your vision.

If your first list runs to ten shots, cut it down. Shorter videos are easier to get right on your first try.

Example: "Help me plan a 20-second video about [your topic]. Give me 5 numbered shots, and for each one list what is on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and any words spoken."

You'll know it worked when every shot has a visible subject, a length in seconds, and a clear purpose in the sequence.

Step 3 — Turn one shot into a clear description

Now take shot number 1 and rewrite it as a short, specific description for the generator. Include the subject, the setting, the lighting, and the camera movement. For example, "slow zoom in" or "camera stays still." Avoid long, crowded sentences. One clear idea per sentence works better than a paragraph of loose adjectives.

Keep your style words the same for every shot, such as "soft morning light" or "warm, cozy colors." Repeating the same look is one of the easiest ways to make separate clips feel like one video.

Do not ask for spoken dialogue in the clip yet. Many generators handle speech and lip movement unreliably, so plan to add voices later in your editor.

Example: "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table in [describe your setting], soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds."

You'll know it worked when your description names the subject, the setting, the light and the camera movement without any confusing wording.

Step 4 — Generate shot 1 and compare it with your plan

Open your video generator and find the text box where you type a description. It is often labeled something like "Prompt" or "Describe your video," but yours may use different words. Paste in

your shot 1 description and choose the length closest to your storyboard. Then start the generation. Wait for it to finish, which can take a few minutes.

When the clip appears, watch it at least twice. Ask yourself: does it show what my storyboard describes? Is the subject visible? Does the motion look roughly right? If something is off, adjust one detail in your description and generate again. Changing one thing at a time makes it easier to see what helped.

If the result looks nothing like your plan, simplify the description and remove extra details. Most early misses come from too many instructions at once.

Example: "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table, soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds." Try "Make the light warmer" as a follow-up adjustment if needed.

You'll know it worked when the first clip matches your written shot 1 closely enough that you could place it in your storyboard without feeling it is from a different story.

Step 5 — Generate the remaining shots in order

Repeat the process for shots 2 through 6, one at a time. Paste the same style words into each description so the lighting and colors stay consistent. Save each clip to a folder on your device, and name the files with their shot numbers, such as "shot-1" and "shot-2." This small habit saves a lot of confusion later.

Expect that not every clip will be perfect. A common reality is that the subject changes slightly from one shot to the next, especially if a person or animal appears in several scenes. If a shot is far off, regenerate just that one rather than starting over. Keep the clips that match your plan and set aside the rest.

Also check the length. If a clip is shorter than you planned, you can trim the others or repeat a short moment in your editor.

Example: "Same soft morning light and warm, cozy colors as before. A hand lifts the mug from the table, camera holds still, 4 seconds."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved file for each shot and each one roughly matches its line in your storyboard.

Step 6 — Put the clips in order and export your video

Open your video editor and create a new project. Import all your saved clips. Drag them onto the timeline in storyboard order, from shot 1 to the final shot. Trim each clip so it matches the

seconds you planned. Most editors have a simple tool for this, often shown as scissors or a small cut icon. If you cannot find it, look for a button that lets you split or shorten a clip.

For a voice, you have two easy options. You can record yourself reading your spoken lines with a voice memo app and add the audio to the timeline, or use a text-to-speech feature if your editor has one. Keep the voice track separate from the clips so you can adjust it on its own.

When everything looks right, export or save the video to your device. Play the exported file from start to finish once before you share it.

💬 Example: "Shot 1 is 5 seconds, shot 2 is 4 seconds, shot 3 is 6 seconds. Place them in that order on the timeline." Use this as a reminder check rather than something you type into the generator.

You'll know it worked when the exported file plays from start to finish in your planned order, with the length close to your storyboard total.

Common mistakes

- **Starting with a long, detailed script.** Beginners often write a full story and hope the AI will split it up. The fix is to write the storyboard first, with short shots, and generate one shot at a time.
- **Changing the style in every shot.** If you describe a new look each time, the clips will not match. The fix is to reuse the same style words in every description.
- **Expecting perfect speech and lip sync from the generator.** Many tools handle spoken words unreliably. The fix is to leave dialogue out of the clips and add your voice in the editor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a short video of a family recipe, a birthday greeting or a hobby project can be planned and made in one evening.
- **For your business or work:** a simple product or process explainer can be sketched as a storyboard, then shared with a team for feedback before any clip is generated.
- **If you're just getting started:** write your storyboard on paper first. Even one good plan will make your first video noticeably better than a random prompt.

Try it now

Take five minutes and write a three-shot storyboard for a 10-second video about something in your room. For each shot, write what is on screen and how many seconds it lasts. You have now done the most important part of making an AI video.

Safely Rename a Batch of Photos with a GitHub Copilot Script

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With GitHub Copilot inside VS Code, you can describe a renaming task in plain English and get a working Python script back — no coding required. The trick is to test on copies first so your originals stay safe.

By the end of this short guide, you'll have asked Copilot to write a small Python script, tested it on copies of your photos, and renamed an entire folder without typing a line of code yourself. If you have a folder of vacation shots named `IMG_4829.jpg`, `IMG_4830.jpg`, and so on, this is for you.

Before you start

- **A computer** running Windows, macOS, or Linux.
- **VS Code installed** — the free code editor from Microsoft (download from `code.visualstudio.com`).
- **The GitHub Copilot extension** installed in VS Code, with a Copilot account signed in. Copilot offers a free tier and paid plans; check the official GitHub page for current availability and which features each tier includes.
- **Python installed** on your computer (download from `python.org`). Python is the language your script will be written in — think of it as plain English instructions for your computer.
- **A folder of photos** you'd like to rename, plus enough free disk space to make a copy. The whole task takes about **15 minutes**.

Step 1 — Make a working copy of your photos

Right-click your photo folder in your file manager, choose **Copy**, then **Paste** somewhere easy to find, like your Desktop. Rename the copy to something like `photos-test`. This is the folder you'll experiment on.

On macOS, you can also select the folder and press Option-drag to duplicate it. On Windows, hold Ctrl while dragging. You'll see a second folder appear next to your originals, with all the same files inside.

If it looks different: If your photos live in cloud storage like Google Drive or iCloud, the same Copy/Paste idea works — just make sure the copy finishes syncing before you start renaming anything. Some file managers hide the "Paste" option inside an Edit menu; look there if right-click doesn't show it.

You'll know it worked when you see two folders: your untouched originals and a clearly named test copy.

Step 2 — Open the test folder in VS Code

Open VS Code, then go to **File → Open Folder…** and pick your new `photos-test` folder. VS Code's left sidebar (called the **Explorer**) now lists every photo in the folder.

A workspace in VS Code is simply the folder you opened — think of it as putting that folder "on your desk" so the editor can see everything inside it. Nothing is moved or copied; VS Code is just looking.

If it looks different: On the VS Code welcome screen, there's a big **Open Folder** button you can click instead. If the Explorer sidebar is hidden, use **View → Explorer** to bring it back.

You'll know it worked when the names of your test photos appear in the left sidebar.

Step 3 — Open the Copilot chat panel

In VS Code, open the **Copilot Chat** panel. The keyboard shortcut is **Ctrl+Alt+I** on Windows and Linux, or **Cmd+Shift+I** on macOS. A chat window appears — usually on the side of the window.

Copilot is an AI coding assistant: you describe what you want in plain language, and it suggests code. You don't have to understand the code right now — that's the whole point of having an AI helper.

If it looks different: If the shortcut doesn't open anything, look for a small chat-bubble icon in the VS Code sidebar, or use the menu **View → Copilot Chat**. Some older versions put Copilot under **File → Preferences** instead.

You'll know it worked when a chat box is visible with a blinking text cursor, ready for your message.

Step 4 — Describe your renaming task in plain English

Click into the chat box and type what you want. Be specific about the folder, the file types, and the new naming pattern. Copilot reads your message and proposes a Python script in the chat.

The more clearly you describe the rule, the better the script will be. If your rule is "rename to `vacation-001.jpg`, `vacation-002.jpg`, …", say that exactly. If you want the date taken included, ask for that too.

💬 Example: `Write a Python script that renames every .jpg and .png file in the current folder to "vacation-2024-001.jpg", "vacation-2024-002.jpg", and so on. Skip files that already match this pattern.`

If it looks different: Copilot might ask a follow-up question like "What folder should I use?" — just answer in the same chat. If it offers several code blocks, pick the one that looks closest to what you asked for and ignore the rest.

You'll know it worked when a code block appears in the chat with a Python script inside it.

Step 5 — Save the script and run it on the test folder

When Copilot shows a script, look for a small **"Insert into new file"** button above the code (or a similar option like **"Apply"** or **"Copy"**). Click it, and VS Code creates a new file. Save this file inside your test folder as `rename.py`.

Now open VS Code's built-in terminal from the top menu: **Terminal → New Terminal**. A text panel slides up from the bottom. Type `python rename.py` and press Enter.

The terminal is a text-based way to talk to your computer directly — instead of clicking icons, you type commands and read text replies.

If it looks different: If `python` isn't recognized, try `python3 rename.py` instead — that's more common on macOS and Linux. On Windows, you may need to install Python from `python.org` and tick **"Add Python to PATH"** during setup for the command to work.

You'll know it worked when the terminal shows your photos being renamed one by one, and the file list in the Explorer updates.

Step 6 — Verify, then run the same script on your real folder

Open the test folder in your regular file viewer (Finder, Explorer, or Files) and check the new names. Open a few photos to make sure none are broken — the picture files themselves shouldn't change, only their names.

If the names look right, you have two safe options: copy your `rename.py` script into your real photo folder and run it there, or ask Copilot to adjust the script so it points to a different folder. Either way, your originals stay untouched.

If it looks different: If a photo won't open, the file may have been partially affected — restore it from your test copy or your originals. If the names look wrong, go back to Step 4 and ask Copilot to fix the rule, then re-test on the test folder before touching real files.

You'll know it worked when your real photo folder shows the clean new names, and every photo still opens normally.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the test folder.** It's tempting to point the script straight at your real photos, but one wrong rule can scramble hundreds of filenames at once. Always run the script on copies first, then on the real folder only after you're sure the names are right.
- **Running the script twice without changing the names.** The second run will keep building on your filename pattern (`vacation-2024-001.jpg` could become `vacation-2024-001-001.jpg`). Either move the renamed files out, or include the "skip if already named" rule in your prompt.
- **Trusting Copilot's first answer without reading.** Copilot is helpful but not perfect. If the script does something you didn't ask for — like deleting files or changing the file extension — rewrite your prompt to be more specific and try again on the test folder.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A folder of 200 vacation photos can go from chaos to `paris-day1-001.jpg`, `paris-day1-002.jpg`, and so on in under a minute. No more guessing which `IMG_4829.jpg` was the Eiffel Tower shot.
- **For your work or business:** Product photos, invoice scans, and event pictures often arrive with cryptic camera names. A two-minute script saves the headache of clicking through 80 files one by one, and the same approach scales to thousands of files.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about learning Python itself — you're learning how to ask an AI for a script. The skill that matters here is describing your rule clearly, not writing the code by hand.

Try it now

Open your test folder in VS Code, open the Copilot chat, and paste this exact message.

💬 `Write a Python script that lists every .jpg file in the current folder and renames them to "sample-001.jpg", "sample-002.jpg", in the order they appear. Print the new names before doing it.`

Run it on a tiny folder of 3 to 5 test files. Seeing those photos rename themselves is the moment this stops feeling like magic and starts feeling like a tool you control.

How to Summarize a Long YouTube Video in 60 Seconds with Any AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a YouTube link into any AI assistant and ask for a summary — in about a minute you get the main points, key quotes, and a one-sentence takeaway without watching. The catch: not every assistant reads YouTube links directly, so we cover that fallback too.

Found a one-hour interview you don't have time to watch? A 40-minute lecture you need for work tomorrow? You don't have to skip it. Any modern AI assistant can read the page a YouTube link points to and pull out the important parts. Here's the whole workflow, start to finish.

Before you start

- **A YouTube link** — the URL of the video you want summarized. It works on desktop, mobile, or in the YouTube app.
- **An AI assistant** you already have access to — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other mainstream option. Free or paid plans both work, though some assistants may need a paid plan to read external links reliably.
- **Roughly 2–3 minutes** for the whole thing, including reading the summary.

Step 1 — Copy the YouTube video link

Open the YouTube video you want summarized and look at the address bar at the top of your browser (or the link shown under the video title in the YouTube app). A YouTube link starts with **youtube.com** or **youtu.be** and ends with a jumble of letters and numbers — that's the video's unique ID. Tap and hold (on phone) or click and drag (on computer) to highlight the whole address, then copy it. On the YouTube mobile app, tap **Share** under the video and choose **Copy link** instead — it's faster. If you're on a TV or game console and don't see a copy option, open the video in a phone or computer browser to grab the link from there. 💬 Example: Your copied link will look something like youtube.com/watch?v=AbCdEfGh123 — the letters and numbers at the end are the video's ID. You'll know it worked when the address is highlighted or your phone briefly says "Copied."

Step 2 — Open your AI assistant

Open the website or app for the AI you normally use. Most readers already have at least one of these: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or Le Chat. Open a new chat — look for a button like **New chat**, **New conversation**, or a + or pencil icon in the corner of the screen. Starting fresh

matters because a long previous chat can confuse the assistant about what you want right now. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box, usually at the bottom of the screen, with a prompt that says something like "Message..." or "Ask anything" — your exact wording may be different.

Step 3 — Paste the link and ask for a summary

Click in the empty message box and paste the YouTube link you copied. Then type your request. A short, clear instruction works best — tell the assistant what you want and how long the answer should be. Press **Enter** (or tap the send arrow). The assistant will fetch the video's public page, read its title and description, and (on most assistants) the transcript too. A short summary appears in under a minute. Example: "Here's a YouTube link: [paste your link]. Summarize this video in 5 bullet points and keep it under 150 words." You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with bullet points or a short paragraph that names the video's main topic and the people or ideas involved.

Step 4 — Pull out a few key quotes

The summary gives you the gist, but sometimes you want the actual words someone said — a striking line, a statistic, or a memorable phrase. Ask for those next. Quotes are useful when you want to share the video with a friend or quote it in your own work. Type a follow-up question that specifically asks for verbatim lines. The assistant will return them with quotation marks and usually say who said them. Example: "Now pull out 3 key quotes from that video, with the speaker's name for each one. Keep each quote to one sentence." You'll know it worked when the reply contains lines wrapped in quotation marks and the speaker is named beside each one.

Step 5 — Get a one-sentence takeaway

A bullet-point summary is great for studying, but a single sentence is easier to remember and share. Ask for the takeaway last. The assistant will compress everything it just read into one line you can use as a reference or send to a colleague. If you have a specific audience in mind — your team, your teacher, your family — say so, because the assistant will word the takeaway differently for each. Example: "In one sentence, what's the single most important takeaway from that video, written so I can send it to my manager?" You'll know it worked when the reply is a single complete sentence (not a paragraph) that captures the main idea.

Step 6 — Save or share your summary

Now that you have the points, quotes, and takeaway, decide where they should live. Most assistants have a **Copy** button at the top or bottom of each reply — tap it to grab the text and paste it into your notes app, email, or document. Some assistants also have a **Share** button that

creates a link you can send to someone. If you don't see either button, you can manually select the text and copy it the same way you copied the YouTube link in Step 1. You'll know it worked when the summary text is sitting in another app — your notes, an email draft, or a message — and you can read it again without opening the AI chat.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the link without any instructions.** The assistant may reply with "What would you like me to do with this?" — always tell it you want a summary, in what length, and for whom.
- **Assuming every assistant reads YouTube links directly.** A few assistants only read the video's title and description, not its full transcript. If your summary feels thin or vague, ask the assistant to look up the video's transcript, or copy the transcript yourself from YouTube (look for an option like **Show transcript** under the video description) and paste that text instead of the link.
- **Trusting the summary on a topic you know nothing about.** Summaries are usually accurate, but AI can still mix up names, dates, or numbers. For important decisions — anything medical, legal, financial, or that affects other people — verify the quote or fact by checking the original video yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time someone sends you a 30-minute tutorial or a long podcast episode on YouTube, decide in 60 seconds whether it's actually worth your time. Skip the noise, keep the useful stuff.
- **For your business or work:** Before a meeting, paste the link to a recorded presentation or webinar and ask for the five main points plus the speaker's recommendations. You walk in prepared without sitting through the whole recording.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one YouTube video you've been putting off, follow the six steps above, and see how much you actually retain from the summary versus the full video. Most people are surprised how often the bullet points are enough.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now, paste the link to any YouTube video you've been meaning to watch, and type: "Summarize this video in 5 bullet points and pull out 2 short quotes." You'll have a usable summary in about a minute — that's the whole skill.

How to Ask ChatGPT for Step-by-Step Photo Editing Help in Your Phone's Editor

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask ChatGPT how to brighten, crop, or remove red-eye in your phone's photo editor, and it will reply with numbered steps for the app you name. It cannot edit your photo for you, and it can only see a picture if your app lets you attach one.

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to describe a photo problem to ChatGPT and follow its numbered steps inside your own photo app. This is for anyone who takes pictures on a phone and wishes they knew how to fix them, with no editing experience needed.

Before you start

- **A ChatGPT account.** You can sign up for free on the official ChatGPT website or app. Image uploads may depend on your plan or app version, so check the app's help screens if the attach option is missing.
- **Your phone's built-in photo editor** (or any photo app you already use). You'll need it open alongside the chat.
- **About 15 minutes.** Two switches between apps are normal, so keep your phone charged.

Step 1 — Tell ChatGPT which photo app you use

Open ChatGPT and start a new chat. Look for a **"New chat"** option, often a pencil or plus icon. Tell the assistant which editor you're using, because menus differ between phones and apps. The reply will be more accurate when it knows whether you use the built-in editor on an iPhone, a Samsung, a Pixel, or another app entirely. If you're not sure of the app's name, say so, and describe the icons you see on the editing screen instead.

💬 Example: "I'm editing a photo on my [phone brand] using the [app name] app. Please give me numbered steps I can follow on my own screen."

You'll know it worked when ChatGPT replies with a short list of steps or asks a helpful follow-up question about your app.

Step 2 — Describe what looks wrong

Be specific about the problem. "It looks bad" is hard to fix, but "too dark," "tilted," or "a bright red glow in both eyes" gives the assistant something to work with. Common photo problems include brightness, cropping (cutting away the edges you don't want), and red-eye (the bright

red reflection flash photos often cause in eyes). Mention one main problem first. Fixing one thing at a time keeps each step easy to follow.

Example: "The photo is too dark on the left side, and I want to crop out the trash can in the corner."

You'll know it worked when ChatGPT's answer addresses your exact problem, not a general photo tip. If it gives you a broad lesson instead, reply with one more detail, such as "the faces are in the center."

Step 3 — Attach your photo, if you can

Some versions of ChatGPT let you share a picture. Look for a **paperclip, plus sign, or image icon** near the message box. Tap it, choose your screenshot or photo, and then send a message describing what you want. Attaching a screenshot of your editor's menu is a great way to get more precise steps, because the assistant can compare its advice to what you actually see. If you don't see any attach option, skip this step and describe the screen in words instead.

Example: "Here is a screenshot of my editing screen. Which button should I tap to brighten the photo?"

You'll know it worked when your image appears in the chat as a thumbnail above your message, and ChatGPT refers to what's in it. If it doesn't mention the image, try resending it or describe the screen in words.

Step 4 — Ask for one fix at a time

Now ask for the steps. Good requests name a single task and ask for numbers, so you can tick off each one. A helpful habit is to add "tell me where to find each tool" so you aren't left guessing. Common tasks include adjusting brightness, cropping to a new frame, or using a red-eye tool, which many phone editors place under an edit or adjust area. Read the list once through before you tap anything, so you know the whole path.

Example: "Give me numbered steps to crop this photo to a square, and tell me where the crop tool usually is."

You'll know it worked when you get a numbered list with clear, single actions, like "Tap Edit" followed by "Choose Crop." If the steps are too vague, ask for more detail on one step.

Step 5 — Follow the steps on your own screen

Switch to your photo editor and go through the steps one by one. If a step says to tap something you can't find, don't panic. Apps change often, so look for an icon that matches the description,

such as a sun for brightness or a square with corners for cropping. Check the result after each step. When the photo looks right, save or export it so your original stays untouched. Many apps let you undo changes if you make a mistake.

💬 Example: "I can't find the red-eye tool in my app. I see a row of icons with a magic wand and a sun. What should I try?"

You'll know it worked when the photo visibly changes after each step, and you can compare it with the original before saving.

Step 6 — Ask for help when the menu doesn't match

Sometimes the steps won't match your screen. That's normal, and you can say so. Describe what's on your screen, and ChatGPT can suggest a different route. Keep the message short, and say exactly which step got stuck. If the advice still doesn't work, the most reliable fallback is your app's own help section or a search for the app name plus the task.

💬 Example: "Step 3 says to tap Adjust, but my screen only shows Filters, Markup, and Edit. What's the closest option?"

You'll know it worked when you get a new route or a clear explanation, and you can continue with the task.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for everything at once.** A request like "fix everything" often produces a long, tangled answer. Fix it: ask for one change per message, such as brightness first, then cropping.
- **Trusting the menu names without checking.** Labels differ between phones and app versions, so a name in the reply may not match yours. Fix it: look for an icon that matches the function, and tell ChatGPT what you actually see.
- **Expecting ChatGPT to edit the photo.** It can explain the steps, but it can't change the picture on your phone. Fix it: keep your photo app open and do each step yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Fix a family snapshot that's too dark, straighten a tilted shot, or crop out a stray hand before you share it with relatives.
- **For your business or work:** Get clear steps for resizing a product photo or cropping a headshot for a staff directory, without learning a complex desktop program first.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one photo you already like and ask ChatGPT for steps to crop it. One small win teaches you more than reading about the process.

Try it now

Open a photo that needs a small fix, open ChatGPT, and send this message: "I'm using [app name] on my phone. Give me numbered steps to brighten this photo." Then follow the first step on your own screen.

Create Royalty-Free AI Music Loops for Podcasts and Videos

5 steps · Read online

Imagine having custom background music for your podcast, YouTube video, or even a presentation, without needing a huge budget or any musical training. By the end of this guide, you'll know how to use Artificial Intelligence (AI) to generate unique, royalty-free music loops that perfectly match the mood of your content. This guide is for anyone who wants to add a professional touch to their projects without the hassle. It's important to know that while AI can create fantastic music, it cannot read your mind or fully understand complex musical theory, so clear instructions are key!

Before you start

- **A device with internet access:** You'll need a computer, laptop, or tablet with a stable internet connection. Most AI music tools, like the one we'll use, operate through a web browser.
- **A Suno.ai account:** This guide uses **Suno.ai** as a practical example. Visit the Suno.ai website and sign up using a Google, Discord, or email account. This process is typically quick.
- **About 10-15 minutes of time:** This is a rough estimate for following the steps and generating your first few music loops.
- **A creative idea:** Have a general sense of the mood, style, or genre of music you're looking for. Do you need something calm, energetic, mysterious, or upbeat?

Step 1 — Sign up or log in to Suno.ai

First, you need to access an **AI music generator**, which is a special online tool that uses **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** — computer programs that can learn and solve problems — to compose original music based on your descriptions. For this guide, we'll use **Suno.ai**, a popular and user-friendly option. Open your web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) and navigate to the Suno.ai website (usually by typing "suno.ai" into your browser's address bar). You'll typically see prominent buttons to "Sign up" or "Log in." Choose the option that suits you, often by linking an existing Google or Discord account, or by creating a new account with your email.

If it looks different: If you're on a mobile device, the layout might be slightly condensed, but you'll still find clear sign-up or log-in options. If you're using a different AI music generator, the exact buttons might vary, but look for similar "Get Started" or "Join" prompts. **You'll know it worked when** you are successfully redirected to a main dashboard or a prominent creation screen, indicating you are logged in and ready to begin generating music.

Step 2 — Find the creation area and understand the prompt

Once you're signed in to Suno.ai, you'll typically land on a page that features a large text box, often labeled "Describe your music here" or "What do you want to hear?". This is your **prompt box** – a designated area where you'll type your instructions for the AI. A **prompt** is simply the text description you give to the AI, telling it exactly what kind of music you want it to create. Think of it like giving a detailed brief to a composer. Look around this area for other settings like a checkbox for "Instrumental" or a "Generate" button.

If it looks different: Some AI music generators might require you to click a "Create" or "Generate" button first to reveal the prompt box. Regardless of the tool, your goal is to locate the main text input field where you can describe your desired music, usually a long, empty box. **You'll know it worked when** you see a clear text input field on your screen, indicating that this is where you'll type your musical vision for the AI.

Step 3 — Craft your music idea (your 'prompt')

Now it's time to tell the AI what to compose! In the prompt box, type a clear and descriptive explanation of the music you're looking for. Consider these elements: the **genre** (like folk, electronic, rock), **mood** (happy, reflective, energetic), **tempo** (how fast or slow the music should be), and **instrumentation** (which instruments you want to hear, such as piano, guitar, or drums). The more specific you are, the better the AI can match your vision. Remember, we're aiming for a **music loop**, which is a short piece of music designed to play seamlessly over and over, so clarity is crucial.

💬 **Example:** `A calm, ambient electronic loop for a meditation podcast, featuring soft synth pads, a subtle bassline, and a gentle, pulsing rhythm. Focus on a peaceful and reflective mood.` **If it looks different:** Some AI music tools might offer specific dropdown menus for genre, mood, or instrumentation instead of requiring you to type them into the main prompt. If these dedicated options exist, it's generally best to use them as they can guide the AI more precisely. **You'll know it worked when** you have typed your detailed musical description into the prompt box, ready for the AI to process.

Step 4 — Generate your music and listen

After you've carefully written your prompt, look for the "Generate," "Create," or "Make Music" button, usually located below or next to the prompt box. Click this button to send your instructions to the AI. The tool will then process your request, using its understanding of musical patterns and your description to produce sound clips. This process typically takes a few seconds to a minute, depending on the tool and the complexity of your request. The tool may generate one or more variations of your music.

If it looks different: While the AI is generating, you might see a progress bar, a spinning icon, or a message indicating that the music is "processing." If you are using a free plan, you might only get one generation per prompt or have a daily limit on the total number of generations you can make. **You'll know it worked when** one or more generated music tracks appear on your screen, each typically accompanied by a play button. Press the play button on each track to listen and determine if it matches your original vision.

Step 5 — Refine and download your chosen loop

It's common not to get the perfect result on the very first try, so don't hesitate to experiment! If the music isn't quite right, go back to your prompt (from Step 3) and make small, precise adjustments. For instance, you could add details like "add a subtle orchestral swell" or change a mood word from "calm" to "serene." Once you find a music loop you love, look for a download button, often represented by an arrow pointing downwards, a cloud icon, or the word "Download." Click this to save your music file to your device. Most tools allow you to save the file as an **MP3** (a common, compressed audio format that balances quality and file size) or **WAV** (a higher-quality, uncompressed audio format ideal for professional use).

If it looks different: The download icon might be found within a three-dot menu (...) next to the track, or there might be a specific "Export" option. On a free tier, some tools may restrict downloads or offer lower-quality files. Always review the tool's terms regarding "royalty-free" usage to ensure you're allowed to use the music for your specific purpose, especially if it's for commercial content like monetised videos; some may require attribution (crediting the AI). **You'll know it worked when** the music file appears in your device's downloads folder or a designated location, ready for you to use in your podcast, video, or other creative projects.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your prompt:** Just saying "happy music" doesn't give the AI enough detail to understand your specific needs.
    - **The fix:** Be much more specific. Add details about instruments ("upbeat acoustic guitar, light drums, simple piano melody"), tempo ("fast tempo"), and exact mood ("joyful and bright, like a morning sunrise").
- **Forgetting about "loop" functionality:** If the tool has a specific "loop" setting, or if you don't explicitly ask for it, you might get a song with a distinct ending that won't repeat seamlessly.
    - **The fix:** Always include "loop" or "seamless loop" in your prompt, e.g., "a seamless electronic loop." If the tool has a dedicated "loop" checkbox or setting, ensure it's ticked before generating.
- **Not checking usage rights:** Assuming all AI-generated music is free for any use can lead to unexpected copyright issues, especially if you plan to monetise your content.

    - **The fix:** Always confirm the AI music generator's terms and conditions, particularly for "royalty-free" usage and commercial licensing. "Royalty-free" usually means you don't owe ongoing payments, but some tools might still require you to credit the AI (attribution).

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily create unique background music for your personal videos, social media stories, or even just for studying or relaxing. This allows you to personalize your digital content in a snap, making your home movies feel more professional or crafting the perfect atmosphere for your focus sessions.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly produce bespoke, original music for marketing videos, online courses, corporate presentations, or business podcasts. This saves significant time and helps you avoid the complex licensing fees and legalities often associated with traditional stock music libraries.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with very simple prompts, like "upbeat acoustic guitar loop" or "calm piano instrumental." Listen to what the AI produces and then gradually add more detail or experiment with different genres.

Try it now

Open Suno.ai on your device, log in, and type a simple prompt like "energetic electronic loop for a workout video" into the prompt box. Click 'Generate' and listen to the results!

Remove Distractions from Photos with Google Photos Magic Eraser

5 steps · Read online

Have you ever taken a fantastic photo, only to have it ruined by a random person in the background, an overflowing bin, or an unsightly power cord? Google Photos' Magic Eraser feature uses a bit of clever Artificial Intelligence (AI) to help you instantly remove those distractions, leaving your pictures looking clean and professional. This guide will walk you through each simple step to make your photos shine.

Before you start

- You'll need the **Google Photos app** installed on your smartphone or tablet.
- You'll need a **Google Account** signed in to the app.
- Pick a photo from your library that has a clear object or person you'd like to remove.
- This feature is generally **free and available** on most modern devices via the Google Photos app, though very heavy or advanced use might have limitations on some free accounts.
- This whole process should take about **5 minutes**.

Step 1 — Open Google Photos and choose a photo

To begin, find and tap the **Google Photos app icon** on your device. It usually looks like a colorful pinwheel. Once the app is open, you'll see your photo library, often displayed as a grid of small picture previews, also known as thumbnails. Tap on the specific photo you want to edit.

What you see: Your device's home screen or app drawer, then your photo library in Google Photos, followed by your chosen photo appearing in full-screen view.

What happens next: The selected photo will open up, filling your screen, ready for you to view or edit.

If it looks different: If your photos aren't showing in a grid, look for a 'Library' or 'Photos' tab at the bottom of the screen. Tap it to see all your pictures.

You'll know it worked when your chosen photo fills the screen, showing all its details.

Step 2 — Find the Magic Eraser tool

With your photo open, you need to access the editing tools. Look for an **'Edit' button** at the bottom of the screen – it often looks like a pencil icon or a set of sliders. Tap this button to enter the editing mode. Once there, you'll see a row of different editing options like 'Crop', 'Adjust', or

'Filters'. Swipe through these options from right to left until you find and tap the **'Tools' section**. Inside 'Tools', you'll then see the 'Magic Eraser'.

What you see: Your photo with various editing icons or tabs appearing along the bottom. After tapping 'Edit', you'll see a new set of options, and then a menu specifically for 'Tools' will slide into view, revealing 'Magic Eraser'.

What happens next: The app transitions from viewing your photo to its comprehensive editing interface. Tapping 'Tools' brings up a selection of smart editing features, including the Magic Eraser.

If it looks different: The 'Edit' button might be a pencil or a 'Settings' icon. If you don't immediately see 'Tools' in the main editing bar, try looking under an 'Adjust' tab or swiping further along the bottom options.

You'll know it worked when you see 'Magic Eraser' clearly listed among the other editing tools, ready for you to select.

Step 3 — Let the AI suggest removals or draw your own

Now that you've selected 'Magic Eraser', the fun begins! The Artificial Intelligence (AI), which is like a clever computer program designed to think and learn, will immediately start analyzing your photo. It's looking for common distractions like people, power lines, or objects that stand out from the background. The AI will then present "suggestions" by highlighting these areas with a subtle, shimmering outline.

What you see: Your photo with the Magic Eraser interface active. You might notice flashing outlines around objects that the AI thinks you might want to remove. Below the image, you'll also see options to 'Erase' (using a brush) or 'Undo'.

What happens next: The AI has completed its scan. If it found anything, the suggested distractions will be highlighted on your screen. If no suggestions appear, that's perfectly fine – you can simply proceed to manually draw over any unwanted areas yourself.

If it looks different: If the highlights don't appear, or the AI doesn't suggest anything, don't worry. This just means you'll guide it yourself. The brush tool will still be active, ready for you to use.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows your photo with potential distractions outlined, or the brush tool is visible, indicating Magic Eraser is ready for input.

Step 4 — Erase unwanted elements

With Magic Eraser active, you have two ways to remove things. If the AI highlighted an object, simply **tap on the highlighted area**. The AI will then try to intelligently remove it and fill the gap with what it thinks the background should look like. For anything the AI didn't highlight, or for more precise control, use your finger to **draw a line or doodle directly over the unwanted object** on the screen. Try to cover the entire object you wish to remove.

What you see: As you tap or draw, the selected part of your photo will disappear almost instantly. The app will attempt to blend the surrounding pixels (the tiny dots that make up your image) to create a natural-looking background where the object once was.

What happens next: The unwanted element vanishes from your photo. You'll see the cleaned-up version right away, giving you a clearer, distraction-free image.

If it looks different: If the result isn't perfect, or if it leaves a blurry patch, don't panic. This tool works best on clear, distinct objects. Simply tap the 'Undo' arrow (often pointing left) at the bottom or top of the screen to reverse the last change and try again.

You'll know it worked when the unwanted object is gone, and the area where it used to be is filled in, making your photo look much tidier.

Step 5 — Refine and save your work

After erasing, take a moment to look closely at your photo. Sometimes, a first pass might leave a slight blur or an incomplete edge. If you need to make further adjustments, you can zoom in by pinching out on the screen with two fingers, and then use the brush tool again for finer detail. You can also use the 'Undo' arrow if you change your mind about a particular erasure. Once you're happy with your edits, look for a **'Done' button** or a tick icon, usually at the bottom-right, and tap it. Then, to save your masterpiece, tap **'Save copy'** (or sometimes just 'Save') at the bottom of the screen.

What you see: Your edited photo still on screen, possibly with 'Done' and 'Save copy' buttons. After tapping 'Save copy', you might see a brief 'Saving' message.

What happens next: Tapping 'Done' exits the Magic Eraser tool, taking you back to the main editing screen. Tapping 'Save copy' processes your changes and creates a brand-new version of your photo in your Google Photos library, leaving your original photo untouched.

If it looks different: The 'Done' button might be a simple checkmark. 'Save copy' might simply be labeled 'Save', or it could appear as a menu option after you tap 'Done'.

You'll know it worked when you see a confirmation message like 'Saved' or 'Copy saved', and you can then find the new, cleaned-up version of your photo alongside the original in your Google Photos library.

Common mistakes

- **Over-erasing**: Accidentally drawing over too much of your photo, or parts you actually wanted to keep, can make the result look unnatural.
    - **The fix:** Always use the 'Undo' arrow immediately if you make a mistake. It will revert your last action, allowing you to try again with more precision.
- **Unnatural background fill**: Sometimes, the AI can't perfectly guess what should be behind an object, leaving a blurry or repetitive pattern.
    - **The fix:** This often happens with complex backgrounds. Try erasing in smaller, more precise sections. If it still doesn't look right, remember that Magic Eraser works best on less complicated backgrounds.
- **Forgetting to save the copy**: After spending time perfecting your photo, it's easy to tap back out of the app without saving, losing all your hard work.
    - **The fix:** Always remember to tap 'Done' and then 'Save copy' (or 'Save') once you're satisfied. Google Photos will usually prompt you if you try to exit without saving, but it's good practice to make it a habit.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Instantly clean up your holiday snaps by removing stray tourists, make family photos picture-perfect by getting rid of background clutter, or simply tidy up a shot of your pet for social media.
- **For your business or work:** Enhance product photos for online listings by removing dust or distracting elements, clear up real estate images by erasing power lines or bins, or prepare professional-looking profile pictures for your business's social media.
- **If you're just getting started:** Look for a photo with a single, clear, distinct object against a relatively uniform background – like a small sign on a wall, or a distant person against the sky. This will give you the best chance of a perfect 'erase' on your first try!

Try it now

Find a photo in your Google Photos library that has a simple, easy-to-remove object, like a small rubbish bin in the distance or a loose cable on the floor. Follow the steps above to magically erase it and see the difference!

How to use Kling AI video templates in Picsart Flow

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Picsart Flow includes Kling-powered video templates that turn a still photo, a character reference image, or a short script-plus-footage combo into a short AI-generated clip. You can try them without editing experience, though longer videos and higher resolution usually need a paid plan.

Want to make a short video but don't have filming skills, a camera, or editing software? Kling is a video-generation model that creates short clips from a still photo, a character image, or a written script combined with your existing footage. Picsart Flow hosts it as ready-made templates, so you mostly just upload, type a sentence, and wait. This guide walks through all three template styles one at a time. None of this requires a video background — only a clear idea of what kind of clip you'd like to end up with.

Before you start

- A free Picsart account (you can sign up with email, Apple, or Google — check the latest sign-up options on the Picsart login page).
- The Picsart app on your phone, or the Picsart web editor on a laptop. Picsart Flow tools may live in different spots in each, so this guide uses language like "look for" rather than exact menu names.
- A few source images saved to your device. For best results, use clear, well-lit photos where the subject is centered.
- Around 15–30 minutes for your first full run-through (most of that is waiting for the AI to render).
- A realistic expectation: AI video is impressive but imperfect. People may look slightly off, hands can blur, and motion can wobble — that's normal for current tools.

Step 1 — Open Picsart Flow and find the Kling templates

Tap the Picsart app to open it, then look along the bottom or side menu for a section called something like **Flow**, **AI Tools**, or **Video**. The exact label depends on your version and platform, so if you don't see "Flow", search inside the app for "Kling" or "AI video" — that usually leads you to the same area. Once you land on the Kling page, scroll until you see a row of template tiles. You'll typically find three styles: one that animates a single photo, one built around a character reference image, and one that combines your footage with a script.

Example: search terms to try inside the app — `Kling`, `AI video`, `photo to video`.

You'll know it worked when you see a screen with several preview tiles, each labeled with the input it needs (photo, image, or footage).

Step 2 — Use the photo-to-video template

Pick the **photo-to-video** template and tap it. The app will ask you to upload one image from your camera roll. Choose a clear photo where the main subject (a person, a pet, a product) is easy to see. After upload, a small text box appears asking what should happen in the video — that's called a **prompt** (the instruction you give the AI). Type one short sentence describing the motion you want, then tap the generate button. The app will show a progress indicator while Kling works. This step usually takes 30 seconds to a few minutes, depending on clip length and server load.

💬 Example: `The woman slowly turns her head to the right and smiles, with soft sunlight on her face.`

You'll know it worked when a short video preview appears in place of the still photo. If it looks wrong, tap regenerate or tweak the prompt — small wording changes make a big difference.

Step 3 — Try the character reference sheet template

Now pick the **character reference** template, sometimes labeled "character sheet" or "consistent character." This one is designed for keeping the same face or outfit across multiple clips — useful for short stories, social media series, or product mascots. The app will ask you to upload one or more images of the same character from different angles. Add a short prompt describing the scene, then generate. Kling tries to keep facial features and clothing consistent, which is harder than it sounds for AI, so your first result may need two or three tries.

💬 Example: `A young woman with short black hair, wearing a yellow raincoat, walks through a misty forest at dawn.`

You'll know it worked when the generated clip shows a person who actually resembles your reference images, in roughly the same clothes and setting. If the face drifts, regenerate or add more reference images — more input usually helps consistency.

Step 4 — Combine footage with a script

The third template, often called **video-to-video** or **script + footage**, lets you feed Kling a short video clip you already have plus a written description of what should change. Think of it as a soft redraw: the AI keeps the general shape and motion of your clip, but re-styles it. Upload a short clip (a few seconds is enough), then type a script describing the new mood, setting, or style. This is the template most people use for stylized social posts — turning a daytime clip into a moody

evening scene, for example. Generation takes longer here because the model has more to process.

💬 Example: `Change the setting to a neon-lit Tokyo street at night, keep the same walking motion.`

You'll know it worked when your uploaded clip now looks visually different (new lighting, color, or setting) while the original motion still feels familiar.

Step 5 — Preview, trim, and export

Once any template finishes, tap the result to open a preview screen. Most flows let you trim the start and end by dragging handles on a small timeline bar. If the clip is too long, shorten it; if the opening is awkward, trim the first second. When it looks right, look for an **Export**, **Save**, or **Download** button — usually at the top or bottom of the preview. On the free plan, you may get a watermark or a lower resolution; higher resolutions and watermark-free exports are typically behind a paid plan. The exact limits change often, so check Picsart's current pricing page if this matters for your project.

💬 Example: trim suggestion — `keep only seconds 2 through 6` (drag the handles until those seconds are highlighted).

You'll know it worked when a finished video file appears in your phone's photo library or downloads folder.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading a blurry or busy photo.** Kling struggles with tiny faces and cluttered backgrounds. Use the clearest, simplest image you have.
- **Writing prompts that are too long.** Two sentences is plenty. Long paragraphs confuse the model and often produce muddled motion.
- **Expecting perfect hands or text.** AI video still fumbles fingers, writing, and small details. If those matter, plan to crop them out of frame or pick a different shot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can turn a favorite vacation photo into a short clip to share with family, without learning video software.
- **For your business or work:** small businesses can produce quick product clips, social teasers, or stylized B-roll (extra footage used to support a story) without hiring a video editor — useful for one-person shops and busy marketing teams.

- **If you're just getting started:** begin with the photo-to-video template on a single clear selfie or pet photo. It's the fastest way to see what Kling can do in under five minutes.

Try it now

Open Picsart, search for the photo-to-video template, and upload one clear photo of someone smiling. Type: `The person gently blinks and turns to look out a window, soft natural light.` Tap generate, wait a minute, and watch your first Kling clip come to life.

How to Turn Your Saved Articles and Notes into a Personal Podcast with Gemini Notebook

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Google's Gemini Notebook (formerly NotebookLM) can read up to about 50 of your own sources — links, PDFs, Google Docs, pasted text — and turn them into a roughly 10-to-20-minute audio conversation between two AI voices. It is free with a Google account, and the audio stays grounded in your sources rather than the open internet.

You've got a folder full of articles, a few PDFs you keep meaning to read, and a commute that could use better company. Gemini Notebook is a free Google tool built for exactly this kind of "I'll get to it later" pile. Point it at your reading list, ask for an audio overview, and two synthetic hosts will chat through the highlights while you walk, drive, or wash dishes.

Before you start

- **A Google account** — any personal Gmail address works.
- **A web browser** on a phone, tablet, or computer — Gemini Notebook runs in the browser, no install needed.
- **3 to 5 sources** to feed it: web links, PDFs on your computer, Google Docs from your Drive, YouTube links, or text you can copy and paste.
- **About 15 to 20 minutes total** for setup plus the first audio generation (the audio itself usually takes a few minutes to cook).
- One honest note: the audio is a *summary* of your sources, not a verbatim read-aloud. If you need every word spoken, this is not the right tool.

Step 1 — Open Gemini Notebook and create a fresh notebook

In your browser, go to the Gemini Notebook homepage and sign in with your Google account when prompted. Once you're in, look for a button that says something like **New Notebook** (it may say *Create* or show a plus-sign +). Click it. You'll see a clean workspace with a left sidebar, a center area that invites you to add a source, and a small notes section. If your screen looks different — Google updates its products often — look for a clearly empty page with wording like **Add your first source** in the middle.

💬 Example: type a short name like "Weekend reading" or "Q3 research" into the notebook title field so you can find it later.

You'll know it worked when a new notebook opens with an empty source list and the Studio panel on the right is ready.

Step 2 — Drop in your first article or PDF

Look for a button or panel labeled **Add source** (it might say *Upload* or *Insert*). Click it and you'll see a small window offering several options: paste a website link, upload a file from your computer, pick a Google Drive document, paste raw text, or add a YouTube link. Pick whichever matches what you saved. For a typical "I've been meaning to read this" article, copy the URL from your browser and paste it in. A short loading indicator appears while Gemini Notebook reads the page, then the source shows up in the left-hand Sources list with a small icon and the page title.

💬 Example: paste the URL of one long article you've been putting off.

You'll know it worked when the source appears in the list with its title — usually within a few seconds for a normal web page, longer for big PDFs.

Step 3 — Build out your reading list

Repeat the same **Add source** action for each article, PDF, or document you want covered. Aim for **3 to 10 sources** in one notebook — enough variety for a meaty conversation, not so many that the summary loses focus. Each source gets its own row in the Sources list. You can mix types freely: two web articles, one PDF report, one Google Doc of meeting notes, and one YouTube link all work together.

💬 Example: add 4 items — a long-form article, a PDF report you downloaded last week, a Google Doc with your own notes, and one more link.

You'll know it worked when every source shows up in the Sources panel and none of them show a red error icon. If one fails to load, remove it and try again — usually a sign-in or link problem.

Step 4 — Generate the Audio Overview

Now look at the **Studio** panel on the right side of the screen. Inside it, look for an option labeled something like **Audio Overview**. Click the button that says **Generate** (the exact wording can change as Google updates the product). A small status message appears — usually "Generating audio overview…" — and Gemini Notebook begins writing a script between two AI hosts, then voicing it. This usually takes **2 to 5 minutes**, depending on how much material you fed it. You can leave the tab open and do something else; it'll be ready when you come back.

💬 Example: type an optional instruction in the custom prompt box if you see one, such as "Focus on the parts about pricing strategy."

You'll know it worked when a small audio player appears in the Studio panel with a play button and a total length (typically between 8 and 25 minutes).

Step 5 — Listen, save, or try again

Press the **play button** ▶ on the audio player. Two voices start chatting through your sources — one asks questions, the other explains, they bounce ideas back and forth like a real conversation. You can pause, drag the slider, and adjust playback speed. Look for a small download or share button near the player if you want to save the file for offline listening; if you don't see one, the audio stays inside Gemini Notebook for that session. If the summary misses the point or sounds off, click **Regenerate** (or a similar refresh icon) — each generation is a fresh script, and quality varies.

💬 Example: while listening, jot down a question in the Notes section on the right so you can ask Gemini Notebook's chat about it after.

You'll know it worked when the two hosts are clearly discussing the *content* of your sources — naming the same people, companies, or ideas from your PDFs and links — instead of generic filler.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting 30 sources at once.** The summary gets thinner and more generic the more you add. Stick to a tight theme: 3 to 10 sources that actually belong together.
- **Trying to feed paywalled or login-only pages.** Gemini Notebook can only read what's publicly accessible on the open web. For paywalled articles, download the PDF or paste the text manually.
- **Expecting the audio to quote your sources verbatim.** It summarizes and discusses them — it does not read them aloud. If you need a literal read-aloud, this tool won't deliver.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Got a stack of "read later" articles about a topic you care about — gardening, parenting, fitness — feed them in and listen on a walk. It's a friendlier way to catch up than scrolling.
- **For your business or work:** Drop in your project briefs, meeting notes, and a few industry reports. The audio overview becomes a quick briefing you can listen to on the way to a meeting.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one notebook, one topic, and three sources you've already saved. That's all you need to hear whether the format clicks for you.

Try it now

Open Gemini Notebook in your browser, create a new notebook, and paste in the link to one article you've been meaning to read. Hit the Audio Overview generate button. By the time you make a cup of coffee, you'll have your first mini-podcast.

How to label AI-made videos when you post them on YouTube, TikTok and Facebook

4 steps · Read online

> **In short:** If your video looks real but was made or significantly changed with AI, mark it before you post. On **YouTube**, select **Yes** under **AI use** in the upload details. On **TikTok**, tap **Next**, then **More options**, and turn on **AI-generated content**. On **Facebook**, Meta requires its AI label for photorealistic video or realistic audio that was digitally created or altered.

More and more videos are made or edited with AI: a cloned voice-over, a generated scene, a face swapped into a clip. Viewers deserve to know when something that looks real isn't. YouTube, TikTok and Meta each have their own rules and their own label. This guide describes each one separately, based on that company's own help pages and announcements, so you can follow the rules wherever you post.

Before you start

- **The finished video,** and a clear idea of which parts were made or changed with AI.
- **Your account** on the platform where you'll post.
- **About 5 minutes per platform.**

Step 1 — Decide whether your video needs a label

Each company sets its own rules. In general, **realistic** AI content needs a label, and small edits usually don't. Here is what each one says.

YouTube says to disclose content that:

- makes a real person appear to say or do something they didn't,
- alters footage of a real event or place, or
- shows a realistic-looking scene that didn't actually happen.

YouTube also asks you to disclose AI music when it's the main focus of the video. It says you don't need to disclose clearly unrealistic or animated content, beauty filters, color or lighting fixes, captions, or using AI only to help write your script, title, or thumbnail.

TikTok asks you to label content that was completely generated or significantly edited by AI.

Meta (Facebook) requires its label for photorealistic video or realistic-sounding audio that was digitally created or altered.

💬 Example: A clip where your cloned voice reads the narration over real footage → label it. A clip where you only used AI to brainstorm the title → no label needed on YouTube.

You'll know it worked when you can say in one sentence what in your video is AI-made.

Step 2 — YouTube: turn on "AI use" while uploading

In **YouTube Studio**, start your upload as usual. In the details, find the **Attributes** section. Under **AI use**, select **Yes** if your video needs disclosure.

YouTube says the label then appears in the expanded description, and for some topics in the video player itself. According to YouTube, disclosing on its own won't limit your video's audience or its eligibility to earn money. Creators who repeatedly don't disclose may have a label added by YouTube or face penalties.

You'll know it worked when your video's expanded description shows the label after it's published.

Step 3 — TikTok: switch on "AI-generated content"

In the **TikTok app**, record or upload your video, then tap **Next**. Tap **More options** and turn on **AI-generated content**. Then post as usual.

On a **computer**, click **Upload**, choose your video, click **See more**, turn on **AI-generated content**, and click **Post**.

TikTok says it may also add a label automatically, for example when you use its own AI effects or when the file carries **Content Credentials** (C2PA) showing it was made with AI. Once a label is on, it can't be removed after posting. Labeled videos still have to follow TikTok's Community Guidelines.

You'll know it worked when your posted video shows TikTok's AI-generated label.

Step 4 — Facebook: use Meta's AI label before you post

Meta says people must use its AI disclosure and label tool when they post a **photorealistic video** or **realistic-sounding audio** that was digitally created or altered, and that it may apply penalties if they don't. Meta shows these posts with an **AI info** label, and it may add the label itself when it detects industry-standard signals that content was made with AI.

Meta doesn't publish step-by-step screens that we could verify, so here's the safe approach: before you post, look for the AI label option in your post or reel settings and turn it on.

If it looks different: If you can't find the option, check Meta's Help Center for the current steps before posting.

You'll know it worked when your published post shows the **AI info** label.

Common mistakes

- **Thinking "it's only a little AI" means no label:** A realistic cloned voice or a swapped face counts, even if the rest is real footage.
    - **The fix:** Use Step 1. If the AI part could make viewers believe something happened that didn't, label it.
- **Labeling on one platform and forgetting the others:** Each platform has its own switch.
    - **The fix:** When you post the same video in several places, turn the label on in each one.
- **Hiding the AI part in the caption only:** A caption alone may not count as the platform's label.
    - **The fix:** Use the official switch. You can also mention it in the caption.
- **Using someone else's face or voice without permission:** A label doesn't make that okay.
    - **The fix:** Only use people's likeness or voice with their clear consent.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you share fun AI clips with friends and family, a label keeps anyone from mistaking them for real events.
- **For your business or work:** Labeling protects your reputation and helps you follow each platform's rules for realistic AI content.
- **If you're just getting started:** Make it a habit. Before you post, ask yourself: "Could someone think this really happened?" If yes, switch the label on.

Try it now

Pick one video you plan to post this week. Write down in one sentence what in it was made with AI, check it against Step 1, and if it needs a label, turn on the switch from Step 2, 3, or 4 when you upload it.

How to Edit Your Phone Photos with Simple Text Instructions in Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Send Meta AI a photo, type what you want changed ("remove the person on the left", "make the sky look like sunset"), and it returns a new version. Simple edits usually work on the first try; complex changes may need a couple of attempts.

Ever take a great photo and then notice a stranger walking through the background? Or snap a sunset shot where the sky came out dull and gray? You don't have to learn a photo editor to fix these — Meta AI can do small edits just by typing what you want. This guide walks through how, on your phone, in a few minutes.

Before you start

- A phone with **Meta AI** available — built into WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, or Messenger. If you don't see it in any of those, the same chat works at **meta.ai** in your phone's browser.
- A Meta account (the same one you use for Facebook or Instagram works).
- One photo saved on your phone that you'd like to edit — landscape, portrait, or a quick snapshot, any of them.
- A working internet connection.
- About **5 minutes** for your first edit, and a little patience if the first attempt isn't quite right.

> **One honest note:** Meta AI is great at small, focused edits — sky color, brightness, removing a clear object. It is not a replacement for a full photo editor like Photoshop. If your request is very complex, the result may surprise you, and that's normal.

Step 1 — Open a chat with Meta AI

Open WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, or Messenger, then find the contact or chat labeled **Meta AI**. It's usually marked with a little blue or purple ring around its profile picture. In WhatsApp, tap the green new-chat button and look for "Meta AI" near the top of your contacts. In Instagram, start a new direct message and search for "Meta AI". A one-on-one chat opens, with a text box at the bottom and a paperclip or + button on the left for attaching things. If you can't find Meta AI in any app, open your phone's browser and go to **meta.ai** — sign in with your Facebook or Instagram account if asked, and you'll land in the same chat. 💬 Example: Open WhatsApp → tap the new-chat icon → tap "Meta AI" in the contacts list. You'll know it worked when a chat thread opens with "Meta AI" at the top and a text box you can type into.

Step 2 — Send the photo you want to edit

Tap the paperclip, +, or camera icon next to the text box, then pick **Photo** or **Gallery** from the menu. Your phone's photo library opens. Select the photo you want — just one to start, so the AI has a clear focus. The photo appears as a small preview in the chat; tap **Send** (the arrow button) to deliver it. The image uploads in a few seconds, and Meta AI now "sees" it. If you're using **meta.ai** in the browser instead, look for an upload icon — usually an arrow pointing up or a small picture frame — on the left side of the message box. Tap it, pick the photo, and send the same way. 💬 Example: One landscape photo where the sky looks flat and gray — perfect for your first edit. You'll know it worked when your selected photo shows up in the chat as a sent message.

Step 3 — Type what you want changed

In the text box right below the photo, write a short, plain sentence describing the edit. Tap send. You'll see three small dots animating while Meta AI thinks — that means it's working. Within a few seconds, sometimes up to a minute, it replies with a new image, usually with a one-sentence acknowledgment like "Here's the edited version." The new photo lands in the chat as another message bubble. If the reply is **only text** with no image, your instruction was probably unclear — try again with the wording in the example below. 💬 Example: "Make the sky look like a bright sunset with orange and pink clouds" — or simpler, "Remove the person on the right" or "Brighten the photo so it doesn't look so dark." You'll know it worked when a new image appears in the chat that looks like your photo, but with the change you asked for.

Step 4 — Look closely at the edit

Tap the new image to open it full-screen. Pinch out with two fingers to zoom in on the area you asked to change. Now look at it honestly: did the edit land where you wanted? Sometimes Meta AI nails it. Other times the change is subtle, or it shifted something you didn't ask to change — a face looks slightly different, or a building in the background got smudged. That happens, and it doesn't mean you did anything wrong. If the image is small and won't zoom in the chat, take a screenshot of your phone (side button + volume up on most phones) — that captures the full-size version for closer inspection. 💬 Example: Ask yourself — is the person really gone, or is there a faint shadow where they stood? Is the sky the color you wanted, or does it look painted on? You'll know it worked when you can decide, honestly, whether this version is good enough to keep or whether you'd like to try again.

Step 5 — Ask for a redo if it's not quite right

If the edit missed the mark, reply in the same chat with a clearer or more focused instruction. Keep the conversation going — Meta AI keeps the photo and your request in context, so you can

iterate. Useful phrases: "Try again", "Make it stronger", "Keep everything else exactly the same and only change the sky", or pointing out what went wrong, like "The person is still there — try once more". If the AI keeps misunderstanding after several tries, start a brand new chat, send just the photo again, and write your best, clearest instruction first. Long threads with many edits sometimes confuse the model. 💬 Example: First try didn't remove the person cleanly? Send: "Try again — remove the person on the right side, but keep everything else exactly the same." You'll know it worked when a new version finally looks like what you wanted — or when you've accepted that this particular edit isn't possible and you'd rather try a different photo.

Step 6 — Save the photo you like

When you're happy with an edited version, save it to your phone. Tap and hold the image in the chat — a small menu appears with options like **Save**, **Save to Photos**, or **Share**. Tap "Save" and the photo lands in your camera roll or gallery, just like one you took yourself. In some apps you'll see a small downward-arrow icon on the image — tap that instead. In **meta.ai** in the browser, long-press the image (or right-click on a computer) and choose "Save image as". Only save once you're sure — once it's in your camera roll, you can't easily get back to the older versions still sitting in the chat. 💬 Example: Save your favorite version, then close the chat. Your original photo is untouched on your phone, and the edited version is now saved next to it. You'll know it worked when you open your phone's Photos or Gallery app and see the edited photo sitting there.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too many changes at once.** "Remove the person, fix the sky, brighten everything, and add a reflection in the water" is too much for one message. The AI may handle one or two of those, badly, while ignoring the rest. **Fix:** ask for one change at a time, and send the photo back through Step 3 each time.
- **Writing vague instructions.** "Make it better", "fix this", or "improve it" leaves the AI guessing — usually wrong. **Fix:** describe exactly what to change in plain words. "Make the sky bluer" works; "nicer sky" doesn't.
- **Not zooming in to check the result.** On a phone screen, a small image can look fine until you look closely — then you notice a smudged face or a ghostly outline where someone was removed. **Fix:** always open the image full-screen and zoom in on the edited area before saving.
- **Saving the first version without comparing.** The first attempt is rarely the best one. **Fix:** wait until you've tried once or twice and you've got the version you actually want, then save that one.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** vacation photos where someone walked into your shot, birthday candles that came out dim, a beach picture where the sky was gray — all fixable in under a minute with one short instruction.
- **For your business or work:** quick product photos, social media posts, or marketplace listings where the background needs cleanup. Type what you want removed, send it through, save the result. It won't replace a designer, but it gets you 80% of the way in seconds.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick a photo that's been bothering you — maybe a great group shot with a stranger in the corner — and try removing them first. It's the easiest edit to see if Meta AI is working for you.

Try it now

Open Meta AI right now in WhatsApp, Instagram, or **meta.ai** in your browser. Send one photo you've taken recently — anything from this week. Then type one short instruction, such as "Make the colors look brighter" or "Remove the trash can in the corner". The whole thing takes under two minutes, and you'll see exactly how the tool responds to your wording — which makes the next edit easier too.

How to Sort and Clean Up a Messy Phone Photo Library with Gemini

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can look through photos you upload, flag near-duplicates, group similar shots, and pull readable text out of old screenshots — all without touching your library. You stay in control: Gemini suggests, you decide what to delete.

By the end of this guide, you'll know how to use Gemini as a careful second pair of eyes for your photo mess — the kind where you have seven nearly-identical sunset shots and a folder full of screenshots you can never search. This is for anyone whose phone gallery has gotten out of hand and wants a low-risk way to start sorting through it.

Before you start

- A free Google account (any Gmail address works). The free Gemini tier is enough for small batches; a paid Google AI plan lets you upload more photos at once and keeps longer conversations in memory — check Google's official site for current plan options.
- The Gemini app on your phone, **or** a browser pointed at the Gemini website.
- About 20–30 minutes for your first batch.
- A folder of photos you actually want to clean up. Pick one small group to start with — don't try the whole library on day one.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Tap the Gemini app icon, or visit the Gemini website in your browser. If you're not signed in, sign in with your Google account. Look for a **"New chat"** button — usually a plus sign or a small pencil icon at the top of the chat list — and tap it. A blank conversation opens. Starting fresh keeps the AI focused on the photos you're about to share, not on a leftover question from yesterday's weather check.

If you don't see "New chat," try the **three-line menu** (sometimes called a hamburger icon) in the top corner — the option to start over is usually inside it. On some devices the same button looks like a small **square with a pencil** inside instead.

💬 Example: tap **New chat**, then wait for the empty text box to appear.

You'll know it worked when you see a clean text box with no messages above it and a paperclip or upload icon somewhere nearby.

Step 2 — Gather a small batch of photos to upload

Don't try your whole library on day one. Pick **10 to 20 photos** that feel like they might overlap — the seven sunset shots from your last trip, the burst-mode photos from your kid's birthday, the screenshots you saved last month. In your phone's gallery, tap **Select** (or hold one photo until checkboxes appear), choose the photos, then tap **Share**, and pick **Gemini** from the list of apps. On a computer, drag the photos straight into the chat box.

If the share menu doesn't show Gemini, copy the photos to your clipboard and paste them into the chat. On older Android phones the upload icon looks like a **paperclip** 📎; on iPhones it's often a small **plus sign** + at the bottom of the text box.

💬 Example: open your gallery, select the 8 beach photos from last weekend, tap **Share** → **Gemini**.

You'll know it worked when the photos appear as small thumbnails in your message and Gemini replies with something like "Got it — I can see 8 photos."

Step 3 — Ask Gemini to flag duplicates and similar shots

Now comes the useful part. In the same chat, type a short, clear question about the photos you just shared. The clearer your instruction, the better the answer. You can ask Gemini to find photos that look almost the same, group them by scene, or just describe what makes each one different. It can read the image content directly — the colors, the framing, who's in the shot — and reason about which ones are worth keeping.

If Gemini's response is too generic, follow up with a more specific question. After a vague "they all look similar," try "Which one is sharpest?" or "Which one best shows both people smiling?" If the free tier says it's reached a limit, work in even smaller batches, or look into a paid plan for larger uploads.

💬 Example: "Here are 8 photos from the same sunset. Can you group any that look like near-duplicates, and tell me which one of each group is the sharpest or best composed?"

You'll know it worked when Gemini gives you a numbered list or short table, like "Group A: photos 1, 3, and 5 are nearly identical — keep #3."

Step 4 — Pull searchable text out of an old screenshot

Screenshots are useless until you can search them. Take a single screenshot — a recipe, an address, a confirmation number, a Wi-Fi password you saved months ago — and share it with Gemini the same way you did in Step 2. Then ask Gemini to read the text out of it and rewrite it in a clean, searchable form. This works for receipts, WhatsApp messages, store hours, anything that ended up trapped inside an image.

The text won't be added back to your photo library automatically — you'll copy it out yourself in Step 6. And Gemini can misread small or blurry text, so for anything important like medical info or legal documents, always double-check the original screenshot.

💬 Example: "Please transcribe the text in this screenshot. Format it as: store name, date, total amount, and any reference number."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with readable text you can copy and paste, and that text matches what you actually see in the screenshot.

Step 5 — Ask for a simple cleanup plan

Once Gemini has analyzed a batch, ask it to summarize what it found into a short, action-friendly list. You're looking for a "do this, then this, then this" answer — not a long essay. The point is to turn Gemini's observations into a checklist you can actually use in your phone's gallery. This is also where Gemini's "context window" (the amount of text and images it can keep track of in one conversation) matters: if your batch is too big, it may start forgetting earlier photos.

If the plan is too long, ask for the top three actions only. If it's missing something obvious, ask a follow-up like "Did you see any photos that look like receipts or notes I should transcribe?"

💬 Example: "Based on what you saw, give me a short checklist of which photos I can safely delete and which I should keep. Keep it under 5 bullet points."

You'll know it worked when you have a short, scannable list that feels doable in under five minutes.

Step 6 — Take the plan into your Photos app

Now switch to your phone's gallery or Google Photos. Open the same batch of photos. Use Gemini's checklist as your guide: delete the ones it flagged as duplicates, keep the sharpest of each group, and save the transcribed text somewhere searchable — a notes app, a contact entry, or a dedicated "Screenshots I've read" album. This is the step where the cleanup actually happens, and it's the step only you can do.

For an extra safety net, turn on your gallery's recently-deleted folder so any mistake can be undone within 30 days. On Google Photos it's usually at **Library → Trash**; on iPhone it's at **Albums → Recently Deleted**.

💬 Example: open the 8 beach photos, delete 5 based on Gemini's notes, star the best one, and paste the transcribed receipt text into your notes app.

You'll know it worked when your batch is smaller, the photos you kept are the ones you actually want, and the old screenshots have become searchable text.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading your whole library at once.** Gemini gets less accurate with very large batches, the conversation becomes hard to follow, and you may hit free-tier limits fast. Work in groups of 10–20.
- **Letting Gemini "decide" what to delete.** Gemini can suggest, but it can't actually delete anything from your phone — and it shouldn't. Always make the final call yourself, in your own gallery, with your finger on the button.
- **Trusting transcribed text blindly.** Especially for numbers, dates, and addresses — Gemini reads most of it right, but a single wrong digit on a confirmation code can cost you a refund. Always glance back at the original screenshot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** That folder of 200 mystery screenshots from the last three years can finally become a few searchable notes — addresses you can find, receipts you can expense, articles you can actually read.
- **For your business or work:** If you snap whiteboards, business cards, or reference material on the go, this same flow turns them into text you can paste into documents, spreadsheets, or your CRM.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick **one** folder — say, screenshots from last month — and run the full six steps on just that folder. Twenty minutes later, you'll have a feel for the process before touching anything bigger.

Try it now

Open Gemini right now, share it the last five photos you took, and ask: "Which of these is the best one, and why?" You'll get a tiny but real taste of how Gemini sees your library — and you'll have deleted nothing by accident.

How to Generate Images with Google Gemini: A Beginner's Guide

6 steps · Read online

Imagine being able to paint a picture just by describing it out loud. Whether you need a quick illustration for a work presentation or a fun graphic for a party invitation, Google Gemini lets you turn your words into custom images in a matter of seconds. This guide will walk you through the simple steps to create your own unique visuals.

Before you start

- **A Google Account:** You will need to be signed into a standard Google account. If you use Gmail or YouTube, you already have one.
- **Access to Gemini:** Open your web browser and go to `gemini.google.com`, or open the Gemini app on your mobile device.
- **Device:** This guide works on any computer, tablet, or smartphone with internet access.
- **Cost:** Image generation in Gemini is currently available for free, though usage limits may apply or change over time with AI tools.
- **Time:** This guide will take approximately 5-7 minutes to follow.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a new chat

First, make sure you're ready to talk to Gemini. When you open `gemini.google.com` in your web browser, you'll see the main Gemini interface, which typically features a large text box at the bottom of the screen and a "New chat" button somewhere near the top. This is your blank canvas for a fresh conversation.

When you click or tap the "New chat" button, the text box at the bottom will clear, indicating Gemini is ready for your first instruction. This prepares the AI for a new request, ensuring it doesn't get confused with previous topics.

If you don't see a "New chat" button, look for a plus sign (+) icon or a menu option like "Start new conversation" in the top-left corner.

You'll know it worked when the text input area at the bottom of the screen is empty and ready for you to type.

Step 2 — Tell Gemini to generate an image

To create an image, you need to write a **prompt** (the written instruction you give to an AI, acting like a friendly request to a helpful assistant). Gemini needs to know right away that you

want a picture, not just text. Always start your prompt with a clear command for image creation. Type your command into the text box at the bottom of the screen.

After typing your command, press the "Enter" key on your keyboard or click the send icon (often a paper airplane or arrow button) next to the text box. Gemini will then process your request, and you'll typically see a "Generating..." message as it works.

If you accidentally just type a description without the command, Gemini might try to answer you with text. Just clarify in your next message, "Please make an image of that."

Example:

> "Create an image of..."

You'll know it worked when Gemini starts to show a message like "Generating image(s)..." or "I'm working on that for you."

Step 3 — Describe your subject with details

An AI **image generator** (a tool that turns written text into digital pictures) needs details to work its magic. Think of it like describing a scene to a friend who has their eyes closed. After your initial command from Step 2, continue to type in the main text box, adding specific information about what you want to see.

When you add more detail to your prompt and press Enter or the send button, Gemini will process this enriched request. It will use these clues to build a more accurate and vibrant picture, displaying the results directly in the chat window.

If the images don't quite match your vision, it often means your description was a little too vague. Try adding more adjectives or focusing on specific objects, colors, or actions.

Example:

> "Create an image of a fluffy golden retriever puppy wearing a bright red collar, sitting on a sun-drenched green lawn next to a yellow tennis ball."

You'll know it worked when Gemini presents you with usually two to four image options that directly reflect the details you provided in your prompt.

Step 4 — Choose your visual style

Gemini can create images in many different artistic styles. If you don't specify a style, it will usually default to a realistic photo. To change the mood or appearance, add style keywords to

your prompt in the same text box where you've been typing. This instructs Gemini on the artistic direction for the image.

When you include a style in your prompt and submit it, Gemini will generate new images that incorporate that specific artistic look. You'll see the images appear within the chat interface, often in a grid or gallery format. This allows you to easily compare different styles or refinements.

If the style doesn't look quite right, try using a slightly different keyword (e.g., "cartoon" instead of "3D cartoon") or being more specific (e.g., "impressionist oil painting").

Example:

> "Generate a watercolour painting of a quiet beach at sunset, with soft purple and orange colors in the sky."

You'll know it worked when the new images Gemini presents clearly show the artistic style you requested, such as brushstrokes for a "watercolour painting" or distinct lines for "line art."

Step 5 — Refine your generated images

Once Gemini generates your images, you might want to make some tweaks. You don't need to start from scratch. You can simply talk to Gemini like a person, typing a new instruction in the text box that refers to the images it just made. This tells Gemini to adjust the previous output rather than starting a completely new image set.

After you send your refinement request, Gemini will consider your feedback and generate updated versions of the images, incorporating the changes you asked for. These new images will appear in the chat, usually below your request.

If Gemini seems confused by your request, try being more specific about which image you want to change ("the last one," "the first image") or what exact element needs altering ("the background," "the animal").

Example:

> "Can you make the sky in that last picture a bit more blue, and add a single sailboat in the background?"

You'll know it worked when Gemini displays new images that show the specific adjustments you asked for, like a bluer sky or a newly added sailboat.

Step 6 — Save or share your image

Once you have an image you like, you'll want to save it or share it. Look for the image within the chat window. Usually, if you click or tap on an image, it will open in a larger view, where you'll find options to download or share.

When you select the download option (often an arrow pointing down, or a "Download" button), the image will be saved to your device's downloads folder or photo gallery. If you choose to share, a menu might appear allowing you to copy the image or share it directly to other applications.

If you don't see a clear download button, try right-clicking (on a computer) or long-pressing (on a mobile device) the image itself; this usually brings up a context menu with "Save image as..." or "Download image" options.

You'll know it worked when the image file appears in your device's downloads or photo library, ready for you to use or share.

Common mistakes

- **Being too brief:** Writing "a cat" will give you a random result. Instead, give Gemini specific details.
    - **The fix:** Writing "a sleepy tabby cat curled up on a knitted blue blanket in front of a warm fireplace" gives Gemini the clues it needs to make something beautiful and specific to your idea.
- **Asking for readable text:** AI image tools sometimes struggle to spell words correctly or make them look natural inside pictures.
    - **The fix:** It is usually best to generate the image without any text, and then add your words later using a simple design app or photo editor.
- **Using negative words:** AI models respond better to what *should* be in the picture, not what *shouldn't*.
    - **The fix:** Instead of saying "a kitchen with no clutter," try saying "a clean, tidy, minimalist kitchen with polished benchtops." Always frame your request in a positive, descriptive way.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can design personalized birthday cards, create unique social media posts, or even generate custom phone wallpapers to match your mood.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly create eye-catching graphics for slide decks, blog posts, or social media updates without needing a massive budget for stock photos or a professional designer.

- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about making your prompts perfect. Just play around, try different styles, and see what the AI creates. The best way to learn is by experimenting!

Try it now

Let’s make your very first image. Copy and paste the prompt below into Google Gemini right now to see what happens:

> **"Create a simple, cheerful cartoon illustration of a happy koala holding a warm cup of tea."**